The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Samādhi of Heroic Progress

Āryaśūraṅgamasamādhināmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 132 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་དཔའ་བར་འགྲོ་བའི་ཏིང་ངེ་འཛིན་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་བཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ།

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Samādhi of Heroic Progress, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Śūraṅgamasamādhi Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as Pakpa Pawar Drowé Tingngedzin, is a Mahāyāna sūtra devoted to a powerful meditative absorption, the "heroic progress" samādhi, through which bodhisattvas advance fearlessly along the path to awakening. The discourse opens on Vulture Peak near Rājagṛha, where the Buddha is accompanied by a vast assembly of monks and tens of thousands of bodhisattvas, praised for their higher knowledges, unfailing memory, inexhaustible eloquence, and steady meditative stability. In this setting the text explores the nature and qualities of this samādhi and the remarkable abilities of those who attain it. It is Toh 132 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of general Mahāyāna sūtras. It should not be confused with the similarly named Śūraṅgama Sūtra of the Chinese tradition, which is a different work.

In the language of India: ārya śūraṅgama samādhi nāma mahāyāna sūtra

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Samādhi of Heroic Progress.

The first fascicle.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was staying at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak, together with a great Saṅgha of thirty-two thousand monks, all of them renowned for their higher knowledges. He was also together with seventy-two thousand bodhisattvas. All of them had attained the wisdom of the higher knowledges. They possessed the quality of non-forgetfulness through dhāraṇī, and the quality of inexhaustible eloquence. They were unmoving, being well established in meditative absorption. They were skilled in knowing how to accomplish the eye of wisdom. They had attained patience, had attained the way of the dhāraṇīs, and had entered the way of the profound Dharma. They had passed through countless ten millions of eons. Their aspirations were perfect. They had vanquished Māra and all adversaries. They had taken up buddha fields of great splendor. They had

donned the armor of great loving-kindness and embraced great compassion. They were vigorous in great diligence. They were skilled in knowing how to teach the explanation of all words. Their conduct was completely pure. They dwelt in the three doors of liberation. They had attained wisdom unattached to the three times. They had emerged from the three realms. They had great devotion to the Buddha and the Dharma. They turned the wheel of Dharma. Their voices were unimpeded, and they brought understanding with pleasing voices. None of their deportment was contrived. They were free from entanglements, beautifully adorned with the major marks, and had donned the armor of never abandoning any sentient being. They possessed mindfulness, intelligence, and realization, and they possessed modesty and steadfastness.

They were such as these: the bodhisattva great being Turning the Wheel of Dharma Unimpeded; the bodhisattva great being Turning the Wheel of Dharma as Soon as the Mind Is Generated; the bodhisattva great being Turning the Wheel of Dharma Without Obscuration; the bodhisattva great being Purifying the Eye, Clean and Stainless; the bodhisattva great being Dispelling All Entanglements; the bodhisattva great being Displaying the Conduct of Joy and Faith; the bodhisattva great being Intelligence of the King Arrayed with Sublime Marks; the bodhisattva great being Endowed with a Mind That Deceives No Sentient Being; the bodhisattva great being Intelligence of an Infinite Ocean of Qualities; the bodhisattva great being Skilled in Knowing the Reversal of Perception; the bodhisattva great being Ever Well Engaged in Steadfast and Vigorous Diligence; the bodhisattva great being Ever Composed, with Undistracted Faculties; the bodhisattva great being Voice That Utters Sounds of Great Joy; the bodhisattva great being Praised by All the Gods; the bodhisattva great being King, Lord of Dhāraṇīs; the bodhisattva great being King of Eloquence; the bodhisattva great being King Arrayed with the Ornament of Eloquence; the bodhisattva great being Mañjuśrī, the Youthful; the bodhisattva great being Maitreya; the bodhisattva great being King Who Holds the Towering Summit of Meru; the bodhisattva great being Oceanic Intelligence Arrayed with Precious Qualities; the bodhisattva great being Great Diligence; the bodhisattva great being Intelligence of Great Array; the bodhisattva great being Banner of Great Jewels; the bodhisattva great being Banner of Light; the bodhisattva great being Glory of Light; the bodhisattva great being Array of Light; the bodhisattva great being Faithful; the bodhisattva great being King of Supreme Joy; the bodhisattva great being Steadfast Power; and the bodhisattva great being Dṛḍhamati. He was together

with these and other bodhisattvas, thirty-two thousand in all.

Moreover, all those who dwell in this great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds: Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, the world guardians, and besides them other gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans, of great splendor, the greatest of the great, who had come and arrived, who had developed roots of virtue, and who had faith in the vast, all of them gathered and sat in that assembly.

Then the bodhisattva great being Dṛḍhamati, who had gathered and was seated in that very assembly, thought: "What kind of questions should I put to the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, so that by asking them the lineage of the Buddha will be upheld, the lineage of the Dharma will be protected, and the lineage of the Saṅgha will be thoroughly upheld; all the abodes of Māra will be reduced to rubble; persons of overweening pride will be thoroughly subdued; sentient beings who have not developed roots of virtue will develop roots of virtue; sentient beings who have developed roots of virtue will increase them greatly; those sentient beings who have not set their minds on awakening will set their minds on awakening; those sentient beings who have set their minds on awakening will become irreversible; those who are irreversible will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; all sentient beings who grasp at objects of reference, and those who cling to a self, will be moved away from those views; sentient beings with an inclination toward the inferior will come to have an inclination toward the vast Dharma of the buddhas; and sentient beings with an inclination toward the vast will be satisfied and supremely joyful? I shall ask all such questions."

Then the bodhisattva great being Dṛḍhamati rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he said to the Blessed One: "If the Blessed One will give me the opportunity to ask questions and have them answered, I would ask the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, about a certain matter."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, the Tathāgata always gives you the opportunity, so as to answer what you ask. Dṛḍhamati, ask the Tathāgata whatever you wish, and by answering each question you ask, I shall delight your mind."

When the Blessed One had said this, the bodhisattva great being Dṛḍhamati said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, is there any samādhi such that, when a

bodhisattva great being dwells in it, he will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; he will not be separated from the buddhas, the blessed ones; he will attain a great illumination, because he illuminates the ten directions; he will perform magical displays through the renown of vast wisdom, in order to subdue all māras; he will gain mastery over gnosis, because he has attained the self-arisen Dharma; he will not depend on others, because he possesses a gnosis not taught by others; his eloquence will be unceasing, because he expounds in detail the eons up to the end of the future; he will attain the bases of miraculous power, because he sustains his life for countless eons; to sentient beings inclined toward the Dharma of the śrāvaka vehicle he will teach the śrāvaka vehicle; to sentient beings inclined toward the Dharma of the pratyekabuddha vehicle he will teach the pratyekabuddha vehicle; to sentient beings inclined toward the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will teach the buddha vehicle; he studies and explains the teachings of the śrāvakas, yet does not enter the certainty of the śrāvakas; he studies and explains the teachings of the pratyekabuddhas, yet does not enter the certainty of the pratyekabuddhas; he studies and explains the teachings of the buddhas, yet does not attain final nirvāṇa; he displays the color, form, marks and attire of the śrāvakas, yet is not separated from the awakening mind; he displays the color, form, marks and attire of the pratyekabuddhas, yet is not separated from the great compassion of the buddhas; because he possesses the developed power of the ten grounds, having emerged through the illusion-like samādhi, he displays the form, color and attire of a tathāgata; possessing his last existence, he appears to dwell in the excellent abode of Tuṣita; because he has developed the power of the roots of virtue, he displays entering the womb, birth, going forth, the practice of austerities, the taming of Māra, and the seat of awakening; because he has developed the power of wisdom, he displays full awakening, being requested to teach, and turning the wheel of Dharma; because he has developed the power of gnosis, he displays everything up to the final nirvāṇa of a buddha; because he has developed the power of samādhi, he displays the destruction of the body; and because he has developed the power of aspiration, he displays even the destruction of the true Dharma?

"Blessed One, what is that samādhi such that, when a bodhisattva great being dwells in it, he displays the manifestation of the arrayed qualities of all buddha fields, displays all that is seen as form, and though passing into complete nirvāṇa, does not thereby pass into final nirvāṇa?"

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Excellent, Dṛḍhamati, excellent! Moreover, Dṛḍhamati, you have undertaken this for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, for the sake, the benefit and the happiness of the great multitude, of gods and humans, and in order to care for the bodhisattvas of the present and the future. Dṛḍhamati, it is excellent that you think to ask the Tathāgata about this matter. Excellent!"

For you, Dṛḍhamati, have served the Victors of the past. You have generated roots of virtue and honored many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of buddhas. You have trained thoroughly in this Great Vehicle. You have gone forth along the paths of deliverance of all the vehicles. You have conquered Māra, the afflictions, and all opponents. For the benefit of the Dharma, you possess the wisdom that has mastery over the qualities of the Buddha. You lead others to take up the wisdom of the bodhisattvas correctly, you gather bodhisattvas together, and you hold the Dharma treasury of all the buddhas. For you, Dṛḍhamati, have received in full the answers to the questions you put to buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges.

Dṛḍhamati, apart from a holy being like you, who has rightly entered the Great Vehicle and donned the great armor, I see no one in this assembly able to ask the Tathāgata about this matter: not a god, nāga, yakṣa, gandharva, asura, garuḍa, kinnara, or mahoraga, not a human or a nonhuman, and not one who has rightly entered the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas. Therefore, Dṛḍhamati, listen well and attentively, and keep it in mind. I will teach you the samādhi which, when a bodhisattva great being possesses it, brings the attainment of those particular qualities, and of others still more excellent by far.

"Excellent, Blessed One," said the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, and he listened as the Blessed One directed. The Blessed One then spoke these words:

Dṛḍhamati, there is a samādhi called Heroic Progress (Śūraṅgama). When bodhisattva great beings abide in that samādhi, they display the magical emanation of the arrayed qualities of all buddha fields, yet they do not pass into complete nirvāṇa. They display every form, yet they do not disturb phenomena from the suchness of form. They go to all buddha fields, yet they have no perception of buddha fields as diverse. They meet all the buddhas, yet they do not divide the realm of phenomena. They appear in every kind of

conduct, yet they know the purity of conduct within it. They take on the role of lord over all gods and humans, yet they do not cause them to grow proud and heedless. They display every domain of Māra, yet they do not engage in the deeds of Māra. They move through all the three realms, yet they do not waver from knowing the nature of the realm of phenomena. They do not die, nor are they born; they take birth among all beings, yet they have no perception of beings as diverse. They teach every analysis of the words of the Dharma, yet they do not waver from the sameness of letters or from realizing the way of the Dharma. They rest in single-pointed equipoise, yet they appear to be engaged in bringing beings to maturity. They possess acceptance of the inexhaustible and the unborn, yet they set forth the arising and the cessation of phenomena. Because they are undaunted in everything, they move with a lion's prowess. They appear in all worldly and world-transcending activities, yet because, like a lotus, they are unattached, they always delight in and are devoted to the supreme pleasure grove of the Dharma.

Then those great śrāvakas, Śakra, the Brahmās, the world guardians, the young gods, and that whole assembly thought: "We had never before heard even the mere name of the samādhi of heroic progress, let alone an extensive analysis and explanation of it. Since we have heard the name of the samādhi of heroic progress, we have truly gained a fine gain. We have truly done well to come to this assembly. We have truly done well to see the Tathāgata. If sons or daughters of noble family who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle hear this analytical explanation of the samādhi of heroic progress and are devoted to it, trust it, and have faith in it, they will without doubt become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. What need then to speak of those who, having heard it, take it up, retain it, read it, master it, teach it extensively to others, and apply themselves diligently to it just as it is?"

Then the Śakras, the Brahmās, the world guardians, and those young gods thought: "We must certainly prepare a lion throne on which the Tathāgata may sit as our offering to him: a Dharma throne from which the Tathāgata will teach this samādhi of heroic progress, a throne for a holy being, a throne of great array, a throne for turning the great wheel of the Dharma." And they thought: "Seated on that throne, the Tathāgata will explain this samādhi of heroic progress." Then each one of the young gods thought: "I am the one who will prepare the Tathāgata's lion throne, and no one else."

Then those sons of the gods, together with Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the world guardians, each prepared a lion throne in order to make offerings to the

Tathāgata. The thrones were of many kinds, beautiful to behold, lofty, vast and spacious. Each was spread with many hundreds of thousands of cushions of fine cloth. Above, in the sky, each was covered with jeweled parasols, victory banners and netting. All around, each was encircled by jeweled terraces. On the right and left, each was adorned with many jeweled trees. Silk tassels were hung, strings of pearls suspended, parasols, victory banners and pennants raised, and canopies spread. Each was covered with nets of golden bells and chimes and strewn with many kinds of flowers. Each was adorned with gold, silver, pearls and gems, beautifully ornamented with arrays of ornaments endowed with the finest of every kind. Gold dust was strewn about. Each was perfumed with divine sandalwood, with fragrances, garlands, powders, unguents and every kind of scent, and many kinds of flowers were scattered. Incense was set out, burning in censers that held the most excellent essences.

Thus, in a single instant, a moment, a brief while, eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of lion thrones were prepared in order to perform acts of offering to the Tathāgata. Yet they did not crowd the assembly or the great earth. No son of the gods saw the throne that any other son of the gods had prepared. Each son of the gods understood that because he himself had prepared the lion throne for the Blessed One (the Buddha), the Tathāgata would sit upon his own lion throne and teach this Heroic Progress samādhi.

Then Śakra, Brahmā, the world guardians, and the other sons of the gods besides them, having prepared lion thrones for the Blessed One, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please sit upon this very lion throne of mine and teach this Heroic Progress samādhi."

At that moment the Blessed One manifested such a display of miraculous power: on those eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of lion thrones he emanated eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of buddhas, so that tathāgatas appeared seated upon all those lion thrones. When he had manifested such a display of miraculous power, each son of the gods saw the Tathāgata seated upon his own lion throne, but none of them saw anyone else's throne. Each Śakra would point it out to a second Śakra, saying, "O friend, look! The Tathāgata is seated on my lion throne!" The second in turn would say to a third, "O friend, look! The Tathāgata is seated on my lion throne!" In the same way, all those Śakras, Brahmās and world guardians, and all those gods, pointed it out to one another, saying, "O friends, look! The Tathāgata is seated on my lion throne!" Then each of them said to each of the others, "The Tathāgata who teaches the Heroic Progress samādhi is seated on

my lion throne, not on yours."

Then, in accordance with what would tame those Śakras, Brahmās, world guardians and sons of the gods, and in order to show just the opening of this Heroic Progress samādhi and to show the full embrace of the Great Vehicle, the Blessed One at that time displayed a sign such that all the Śakras, Brahmās and world guardians, and those sons of the gods, saw eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of buddhas seated upon those eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of lion thrones.

Then all those in the assembly were filled with wonder. They rose from their seats, and all of them joined their palms, bowed to the Tathāgata, and spoke these words: "Excellent, excellent! It is a wonder that the Tathāgata has thus fulfilled the wishes of these sons of the gods. The domain of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is inconceivable."

Thus all the sons of the gods who had prepared lion thrones for the Buddha, having seen this miraculous display of the Tathāgata's magical manifestation, all generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in order to make offerings to the Tathāgata, to pacify the suffering of all sentient beings, to uphold the sacred Dharma, and to keep the lineage of the buddhas unbroken. Blessed One, just as now the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, performs magical manifestations, so may we too in the future abide in the domain of the buddhas and perform magical manifestations."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to those sons of the gods, saying, "Excellent! Excellent! Sons of the gods, it is just so. Sons of the gods, it is just as you have said. Generating the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in order to pacify the suffering of all sentient beings, to uphold the sacred Dharma, and to keep the lineage of the buddhas unbroken is the supreme offering to the Tathāgata."

Then, from within that assembly of Brahmās, a Brahmā called Abiding in Sameness said to the Blessed One, "Is the real Tathāgata the one seated on my lion throne, or the one seated on another's lion throne?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the Brahmā Abiding in Sameness, "Brahmā, because all phenomena have no owner, they arise like illusions. They are present through projection, they have the characteristic of

being without an agent, and they arise from conceptual imagining. However one wishes them to be, just so are they projected. Brahmā, none of these tathāgatas is real."

"Brahmā, how is it that all these Tathāgatas are not real? They are not true, and because they are not true, they are not real. They have not come into being, nor will they come into being; therefore they are not real. They are not included in the great elements; therefore they are not real. They are not included in the aggregates, not included in the elements, and not included in the sense sources; therefore they are not real. They are not real, not born, and have not come into being; therefore they are not real. They are not real: as they are at the beginning, so they are at the end, and so they are in the middle; therefore they are not real. Brahmā, all these Tathāgatas are equal, without any distinction."

Brahmā asked, "Blessed One (the Buddha), why are all these Tathāgatas equal, without any distinction?"

The Blessed One said, "Brahmā, these Tathāgatas are equal through the suchness of form, and equal through the suchness of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness; therefore they are equal. Brahmā, all these Tathāgatas are equal through the suchness of the prior extreme, equal through the suchness of the final extreme, and equal through the suchness of the present. Brahmā, these Tathāgatas are equal through the suchness of phenomena that are like illusions, and equal through the suchness of phenomena that are like mirages; therefore they are equal. Brahmā, these Tathāgatas are equal through the suchness of the future, equal through the suchness of the present, and equal through the suchness of non-attachment; therefore they are called equal. Whatever all phenomena are equal to, these too are equal to that. Whatever all sentient beings are equal to, these too are equal to that. Whatever all buddhas are equal to, these too are equal to that. Whatever all buddha fields are equal to, these too are equal to that. And so, Brahmā, these Tathāgatas do not pass beyond sameness; therefore they are equal. Brahmā, therefore these Tathāgatas have not passed beyond sameness; therefore they are equal. Brahmā, for that reason the Tathāgata has thus fully and perfectly awakened to all phenomena as equal, and therefore the Tathāgata is called one who abides in the sameness of all phenomena."

Then the Brahmā Abiding in Sameness said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Tathāgata, having thus fully and perfectly awakened to the sameness of all phenomena, also displays a perfected form body to sentient beings."

The Blessed One said, "Brahmā, that is the special result of having trained in the samādhi of heroic progress (śūraṅgama) in the past. Because of this, the Tathāgata, having thus fully and perfectly awakened to the sameness of all phenomena, also displays a perfected form body to sentient beings."

When this teaching on seeing the Tathāgata was explained, the Brahmā Abiding in Sameness obtained the patience that conforms to the Dharma. The god Throne also obtained the patience that conforms to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One withdrew that miraculous display and made all those bodies of the Tathāgata disappear, and that whole assembly saw only a single Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Dṛḍhamati, the samādhi of heroic progress is not attained by a bodhisattva who abides on the first ground. It is not attained by one who abides on the second ground, nor by one who abides on the third ground, nor by one who abides on the fourth ground, nor by one who abides on the fifth ground, nor by one who abides on the sixth ground, nor by one who abides on the seventh ground, nor by one who abides on the eighth ground. It is not attained by a bodhisattva who abides on the ninth ground. Dṛḍhamati, the samādhi of heroic progress is attained by a bodhisattva who abides on the tenth ground."

Dṛḍhamati, what then is the Heroic Progress samādhi? It is as follows. It is to have thoroughly purified the generation of the mind of awakening, so that it is like the element of space; to have direct perception of the thoughts in the minds of all sentient beings; to know the higher and lower faculties of all sentient beings; to have direct discernment of what is possible and what is impossible; to know how, in every distinction of karma, the karmic maturation comes about; never to forget how to enter into the various inclinations of beings; to have direct perception of the various elements and the many elements; the voice of Brahmā; sporting in samādhi; seeing and knowing the vajra-like samādhi; having all samādhis and meditative attainments become one; discerning, through knowledge, the path that leads everywhere; unobstructed knowledge in recollecting former lives; seeing with the unhindered divine eye; knowing how to attain at a single time, for the sake of

exhausting and abandoning the defilements; knowing how to enter into the equality of form and the formless; sporting by displaying all forms and by magical emanations; all sounds and speech being equal to echoes; the branches of the voice being pure; knowing how to enter into the dhāraṇīs; satisfying all sentient beings with eloquent speech; teaching the Dharma to each as suits them; discerning the right time and the wrong time; knowing how faculties change; teaching the Dharma that is never without benefit; knowing how to enter into the limit of reality; knowing skill in gathering all sentient beings and in subduing them; completely perfecting all the perfections; conduct that is unpremeditated; completely destroying all thought, conceptualization, and imagining; knowing how to enter the plane of equality of the undifferentiated sphere of phenomena; in an instant displaying a body at the feet of all the Tathāgatas; retaining and never forgetting the Dharma taught by all the Tathāgatas; emanating mirage-like bodies in all world systems; skill in teaching the deliverance of all the vehicles; never falling away from the Great Vehicle; upholding the lineage of the Three Jewels; wearing firm armor through eons that reach to the very end of the future, never growing weary; displaying conduct suited to each in all places of birth; skill in knowing how to bring all sentient beings to maturity; a depth that the wisdom of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas can hardly fathom; knowing how to demonstrate the accomplishment of all the branches of the voice; knowing the state that surpasses all phenomena; making countless eons enter into a single eon, and a single eon enter into countless eons; a single field gathering and entering into all fields; knowing how to display all fields within a single field; knowing how to make inconceivable buddha fields, just as they are perceived, enter into the breadth of a single hair; knowing how the bodies of all sentient beings gather and enter into the body of a single sentient being; realizing all buddha fields to be equal to space; filling one's own body to the full with every buddha field without exception; one's own body conforming to all bodies; skill in realizing all phenomena to be without characteristics; skill in all means; knowing the activity of skill in all means; a single sound uttered resounding throughout the entire sphere of phenomena; starting from a single word and expounding it for countless eons; realizing all phenomena as the qualities of a buddha; knowing skill in teaching all the divisions of the words of the Dharma; analyzing by knowing skill in what applies and what does not apply; knowing how to teach in paired sequence and in interwoven sequence; knowing how to pass completely beyond all the deeds of Māra; emitting rays of wisdom and gnosis through skill in great means; actions of body, speech,

and mind preceded by gnosis; manifesting and attaining miraculous powers that require no deliberate effort; satisfying all realms of sentient beings with the four kinds of analytical knowledge; displaying emanations pervading the entire sphere of phenomena; embracing all sentient beings with the four means of attraction; understanding all the conventions of sentient beings in all world systems; having no doubt in accomplishing phenomena that are like illusions; perfectly attaining mastery over all births; attaining mastery over requisites; satisfying all sentient beings according to their wishes; regarding those of corrupt discipline and those possessed of moral discipline with an equal mind as worthy recipients of offerings; attaining all the secrets of the bodhisattvas; emitting rays of light into all world systems; knowing the ocean of omniscience, so hard to fathom; a mind equal to earth, water, fire, and wind; turning the wheel of Dharma in all teaching of words; entering the ground of the Tathāgata; patience gained by oneself without being taught, and the attainment of gnosis; through generating a jewel-like mind, being unstained by the stains of all the afflictions; making all the masses of water enter a single pore, without harming even the sentient beings who live in the water; knowing the activity of skill in dedicating the essence of merit that gathers immeasurable roots of virtue; unobstructed gnosis regarding the conduct and the transformations of all sentient beings; attaining confidence in the complete awakening to all the qualities of a buddha; displaying everywhere, through the aspirations of one's own body, the unbroken continuity of the conduct that takes care of sentient beings; entering the domain of all the buddhas; direct discernment of the gnosis of the Tathāgata; entering the secret of the Tathāgata; displaying every kind of play, joy, and enjoyment; a mind that is peaceful, utterly peaceful, and thoroughly calmed; the perfect retention of immeasurable learning; unceasing diligence in all learning; conforming to the various kinds of worldly activity; remaining unstained by all worldly concerns;

blessing countless eons into a single morning and teaching the Dharma; displaying, in every kind of deportment, muteness, lameness, hardness of hearing, dull-wittedness, deafness, and blindness, and so bringing sentient beings to maturity; covering every buddha field without exception with the faculty of the tongue; displaying the appearance of a buddha in world systems where there is no buddha; being constantly followed by a hundred thousand Vajrapāṇis; directly perceiving the self-arisen gnosis of the awakening of all buddhas; displaying the eon of burning to sentient beings who conceive of

permanence; blessing the span of life to last hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of immeasurable eons; displaying all buddha fields in a single instant, moment, or split second of mind, and knowing beings; displaying the deportment of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas; never interrupting any of the conduct of a bodhisattva; being peaceful, utterly peaceful, and thoroughly calmed; abiding in signlessness; producing the sounds and melodies of cymbals, of beaten drums, and of music; never ceasing to behold all the tathāgatas, to attend upon them, and to make offerings to them; bringing to maturity limitless and measureless sentient beings through their hearing, seeing, bowing, longing, approaching, attending, and recollecting; in each successive moment of mind, displaying perfect, complete awakening and liberation according to how the beings to be trained are ripened; displaying the bodhisattvas' entry into the womb, birth, going forth, practice of austerities, going to the seat of awakening, taming of Māra, attainment of perfect and complete awakening, turning of the wheel of Dharma, great parinirvāṇa, and even the destruction of the body, yet without abandoning that very nature of a bodhisattva, and without passing into the nirvāṇa in which the aggregates are utterly absent. This, Dṛḍhamati, is called the samādhi of heroic progress. This is the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress. There are also others beyond measure. On this it is said:

Just as space is pure
And does not become stained by dust,
So too one who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress
Cultivates the mind in just that way.

Because he knows the minds
Of all embodied beings, with all their aspects,
For that reason he is great-souled,
And thoroughly knows their characteristics.

By realizing and understanding heroic progress,
He knows the faculties of sentient beings,
The sharp and the dull,
And what is possible and what is impossible.

The distinctions among all bodies,
The various ripenings of karma,
And the inclinations of sentient beings:
These that heir of the Sugata comes to know.

Skilled in the realms of sentient beings,
He does not become attached.
Because he is not deluded,
He comes to know the samādhi of Brahmā's voice.

Having come to know, with firmness,
The samādhi of the vajra essence,
He rests evenly in samādhi
And sees as though it lay in his hand.

The supreme ones that go everywhere,
Which are the path of all dharmas,
As the Sage has taught them:
These are realized by this one.

Then he enters into the knowledge
Of his former abodes,
And with the stainless divine eye
He sees the beings.

Though he has exhausted the defilements,
That wise one does not pass into nirvāṇa.
He knows that the characteristic of the formed and the formless
Is one and the same.

Just as magicians
Play in all sorts of ways,
So that hero, through samādhi,
Displays all forms in sequence.

The sameness of all sounds,
Pure like an echo,
And the languages of all sentient beings
He knows in a single instant.

Since he possesses dhāraṇī and wisdom,
He swiftly enters into the workings of speech,
And realizes just as it is
The initial limit of sound and voice.

With stainless mindfulness and intellect,
He swiftly enters where the Sages have gone.
Through his good teaching he gladdens

The minds of beings, without any wrongdoing.

To sentient beings, as suits each one,
The arhat teaches the Dharma.
With his intellect he discerns
The right time and the wrong time for people.

Having understood, according to the proper method,
Exactly how the faculties arise,
Again and again,
The steadfast supreme one teaches what is meaningful.

The subtle limit of reality
He realizes, free of sickness.
In gathering beings and in restraining them
He becomes skilled at all times.

He has destroyed all thought and conceptualization,
Unobscured by imagining,
He has reached the far shore of the perfections,
And does not conceptualize deportment.

The dharmadhātu, which is free of all mixture,
He comes to realize through wisdom.
Before whatever buddhas dwell in the directions
He appears, all of them, even in a single instant.
Whatever teachings of the Dharma
All the tathāgatas give,
The wise one takes up every one of them
And never falls into confusion.
With bodies that are like mirages
He appears in every realm.
Free of all ills, encompassing every vehicle,
The intelligent one teaches just as a buddha does.
Steadfast in his discipline,
He never falls away from the Great Vehicle,
And to keep the lineage of the Three Jewels alive,
He teaches in this way, in three modes.
Though he has donned the armor to the final limit of time,
He never grows weary.

Born of compassion,
He appears in every class of beings.
Supremely intelligent,
He displays every manner of birth;
Skilled, he swiftly brings
All beings to full maturity.
Because he knows the intentions of all beings
And the range of their minds,
He is therefore hard to fathom
For śrāvakas and for all embodied beings.
Where there is no duality,
There he perfects every component of the voice.
Peaceful and exalted above all phenomena,
He teaches the immeasurable Dharma.
Knowing liberation, within a single eon
He displays many eons.
Eons of many kinds
He displays as a single eon.
Realms of many kinds
He displays as a single realm.
A single realm he displays
As realms of many kinds.
Even on the tip of a single hair
He displays all the realms.
Likewise, in a single body
The sinless one displays all bodies.
He realizes all realms
To be pure, just like space.
With his own body
He pervades all the realms.
He knows fully that his own body
And the dharmadhātu are equal.
He realizes the dharmadhātu
As signless and without appearance.
Skilled in various means,
His voice is inconceivable, like space.
Knowing the meaning, he takes up a single word

And expounds it for an eon.
The great being realizes all phenomena
To be the Dharma of the Buddha.
In the analysis and exposition of words
His skill comes into its own.
In various kinds of sequence
He composes in pairs and in reverse order.
Having suppressed the paths of Māra,
He sends forth light rays from his body.
His actions of body,
Speech, and mind are preceded by wisdom.
Life after life
He gains miraculous powers.
Having developed the strength of the discernments,
The powerful one, within the dharmadhātu,
Performs many transformations
And teaches the unmoving state.
Through the four means of attraction
He gathers beings as if each were his only child.
He comes to know their speech,
Their sounds, and their languages.
Blessing phenomena that are like illusions,
He works transformations.
He abides in birth among all beings
And appears like space.
Just like Vaiśravaṇa,
Having gained wealth endowed with every requisite,
He fulfills all the wishes
And aims of beings.
Toward those of corrupt discipline and those of pure discipline
His mind remains equal.
Even the secrets of the buddhas
This holy person comes to know.
Making a net of light rays,
He pervades the world systems.
Possessed of wisdom, he is hard to fathom in his depth,
Like the great ocean full of water.

His mind is like earth, water, and fire,
Like wind and like space,
And it always engages with beings
Out of loving compassion.
He who dispels existence,
Having attained the sublime acceptance of non-arising,
Like a pure and precious jewel,
Is likewise untainted by afflictions.
Into a single pore
He draws all the masses of water;
He sports for great eons
And brings virtue to perfection.
In the work of dedication
His knowledge is never confused;
Knowing the conduct of beings,
He performs great miracles.
In order to realize all phenomena
His mind is ever engaged.
His body is purified and without stain,
Free of sorrow, without avarice.
From what beings are born,
The irreproachable one knows.
Even the domain of the buddhas
The supreme speaker knows fully.
Whatever the Tathāgata knows,
All of it he examines.
All the secrets of the buddhas
He comes to understand.
Whatever play and delights there are,
All of these he displays.
Through learning without measure
He attains an ocean of learning;
In his search for learning he is never sated.
Acting in harmony with the ways of the world,
He is untainted by the world,
Just like a lotus in a pond.
Even within a single morning

He displays many eons.
He shows himself
In the form of a fool or a mute.
In the company of thousands of Vajrapāṇis
He brings beings to maturity.
He constantly knows what is self-arisen
And contemplates that very thing.
A lifespan of inconceivable eons
He displays in a single instant.
He even displays
The activities of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas,
Yet he always follows
The conduct of a bodhisattva.
His mind is ever peaceful,
Utterly calm, and without aggregates.
He knows how to play every instrument
That brings delight to beings.
Prostrating to the buddhas
And honoring them, he never gives up.
By being seen and by being heard
He brings many beings to maturity.
In a single instant
He displays beings of many kinds.
In some places the hero displays birth,
Renunciation, and death.
In some he passes into parinirvāṇa;
In some he turns the wheel.
In some he utterly crushes the māras;
In some he practices austerities;
Yet in order to liberate beings
He never passes wholly into nirvāṇa.
Such is the domain
Of the samādhi of heroic progress:
Whoever has attained that samādhi,
Stainless, sports in this way.

Dṛḍhamati, this is called the samādhi of heroic progress, and this too is the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress. There are countless others as well. Dṛḍhamati, in this way the samādhi of heroic progress is the teaching of the immeasurable. It displays the domain of all the buddhas and the array of their realms. It sustains all beings. It benefits all beings.

Dṛḍhamati, the samādhi of heroic progress is not to be regarded as a single explanation. It is not a single domain, not a single aspect, and not a single object of focus, and it is not to be regarded as arising from a single thing. Why is that? Dṛḍhamati, all samādhis, all meditative attainments, all liberations, the miraculous powers, the superknowledges, and the knowledges of the analytical understandings (pratisaṃvid): all of these are to be regarded as gathered and included within the samādhi of heroic progress.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. All the springs, ponds, pools, lakes, streams, rivers and great rivers there are, whatever their number, are seen to flow together into the great ocean. In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, all the samādhis, meditative attainments and liberations of bodhisattvas, whatever their number, all the miraculous powers, the superknowledges and the knowledges of the analytical understandings, are all to be regarded as gathered within the samādhi of heroic progress.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. The entire fourfold army of a king is in the hands of the hero who goes into battle and is under his command. Wherever the hero who goes into battle goes, there the fourfold army goes as well. In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, all gateways of samādhi, gateways of meditative attainment, gateways of abiding in the Dharma, gateways of liberation, gateways of dhāraṇī, and gateways of superknowledge, knowledge and release, whatever their number, all these gateways of abiding in the Dharma are in the hands of the samādhi of heroic progress, under its command, and made manifest by it. Dṛḍhamati, wherever the bodhisattva's samādhi of heroic progress goes, to that very place all the gateways of abiding in the Dharma go as well.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. Wherever a universal monarch goes, there his seven precious treasures go as well. In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, wherever the samādhi of heroic progress goes, there all the factors conducive to awakening go too and follow after it. Therefore it is called the samādhi of heroic progress.

The second fascicle.

Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress is not to be regarded as one who seeks out possessions and then distributes gifts.

Dṛḍhamati, whatever jewels there are in a great trichiliocosm, whether they are in the great ocean, in the abodes of the gods, in the abodes of the nāgas, upon the great earth, in the hands of yakṣas, or in the world of humans, be they jewels or food, drink, clothing or vehicles, over all of these he is master, and all of them are under his control. He gives to whomever he wishes to give. And if even that is obtained through past merit, what need is there to speak of accomplishing miraculous powers by the mind? Dṛḍhamati, this is to be regarded as the distinctive way in which a bodhisattva abiding in the samādhi of heroic progress purifies the perfection of generosity.

Moreover, Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress does not take up moral discipline, for he never wavers from the very nature of moral discipline; yet in order to train other beings he does take up moral discipline, he does uphold the precepts, he does teach the rites and modes of conduct, and he also knows how to be restored from transgressions. He also confesses and repents, yet in all of this he possesses the quality of being without transgression. In order to bring beings to maturity he is born in the desire realm. Having become a universal monarch, he is escorted by throngs of women going before him, dwells amid his retinue of queens, and appears to enjoy sense pleasures. He even lives in a household beset by sons, daughters and a wife. Yet he is free of desire, abides in the very nature of samādhi, is perfectly pure in moral discipline, and, having seen clearly, regards existence as faulty. Dṛḍhamati, this is to be regarded as the distinctive way in which a bodhisattva abiding in the samādhi of heroic progress purifies the perfection of moral discipline.

Moreover, Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress abides in patience because all things are utterly momentary. He cultivates patience because all beings are unborn. He cultivates patience because all phenomena have never arisen. He cultivates patience because mind has no form. He cultivates patience because he does not give rise to a self. He cultivates patience because he does not apprehend another. He cultivates patience because he has no conceit regarding saṃsāra. He cultivates patience by way of the intrinsic nature of nirvāṇa. He cultivates patience because by intrinsic nature there is no division. He cultivates patience, yet he cultivates no phenomenon whatsoever, nor is he separated from cultivation.

Abiding in patience in this way, in order to bring beings to maturity he is born in the desire realm. He appears as a lord who reviles others, yet by the nature

of reality he does not revile. He appears as a lord filled with malice, yet, having meditated on essential nature, he does not act with malice. He appears hard to approach, yet he stays neither near to nor far from any phenomenon whatsoever. In order to bring beings to maturity he even throws all his modes of deportment into disarray, yet he does not truly see the realm of phenomena as disturbed. He speaks words of patience, yet he does not accept any phenomenon whatsoever as permanent, stable, everlasting or unchanging. Endowed with patience in this way, to beings who abound in malice, hostility, aversion and anger he speaks in praise of patience, so that they may abandon malice, hostility, aversion and anger; yet he apprehends neither malice nor patience, and at all times he remains without appearance and without decline. Dṛḍhamati, this is to be regarded as the distinctive way in which a bodhisattva abiding in the samādhi of heroic progress purifies patience.

Moreover, Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) exerts diligence in order to seek all virtuous qualities, yet he is not worn out in body, nor is he worn out in speech or mind. He displays this exertion of diligence for the sake of lazy beings, thinking, "How might they, looking at me, train in just the same way and apply themselves in the same way?" Though he exerts diligence, there is no exertion at all anywhere. Why is that? Because that bodhisattva has realized that the abiding of the realm of phenomena neither comes nor goes. Abiding in this way, he displays a diligence free of body, speech, and mind, yet he does not see any phenomenon as fully established.

He appears to have exerted diligence, yet his body, outer or inner, is not worn out at all. Though he goes to and comes from countless buddha fields, he does not stir from the true nature of the body. He displays the undertaking of every virtue, yet he does not apprehend any phenomenon, whether virtuous or nonvirtuous. He appears to seek learning, yet for the awakening of all the buddhas he depends on no one else. He seeks preceptors and masters, yet he is himself the master of the world with its gods. He appears to join his palms and learn all the teachings, yet he has attained unobstructed eloquence. He appears to show respect, yet the world with its gods shows respect to him.

He displays lying in the womb, yet he is not stained by any of the impurities of the womb. He displays being born, yet he sees no phenomenon that arises or ceases. He displays the form of a child, yet all his faculties are complete. He appears to study the crafts, the physical arts, the sciences, the domain of mantra, elixirs, medicine, writing, reckoning on the fingers, numbers, and

calculation, yet he has fully understood every craft. He displays falling ill, yet he is free of every disease of the afflictions. He displays growing old, yet none of his faculties decline. He displays dying, yet he is neither born nor dies, neither transmigrates nor arises.

Thus, Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress possesses such a practice of diligence.

Moreover, Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress knows that all phenomena are by their very nature in a state of absorption, yet he also displays a discerning practice of samādhi and meditative concentration. In order to draw beings whose minds are distracted into samādhi, he displays himself abiding in meditative concentration, yet he sees no phenomenon in the realm of phenomena that is distracted. He reflects with certainty in his mind, and abides in it, that all phenomena are equal to whatever the realm of phenomena is equal to, and he does not waver from samādhi and one-pointedness of mind. He rests in equipoise, yet he comes and goes, sits and stands, walks about and lies down. He displays all the forms of conduct, yet he remains single-mindedly absorbed. He appears to speak, yet he does not abandon the very nature of samādhi.

Thus, Dṛḍhamati, whenever the bodhisattva goes into and enters villages, cities, towns, districts, countries, and the precincts of royal palaces in order to benefit other beings and other persons, even then he is in equipoise. Whenever he eats food out of compassion for other beings and other persons, even then he eats while remaining in equipoise. He appears to eat, yet the body of that bodhisattva is wholly solid, firm, substantial, like a vajra, not hollow, and indestructible. Inside that bodhisattva there are no intestines and no stomach, no feces and no urine, no mucus and no spittle, no impurity, and no foul smell. He neither chews nor swallows; there is no eating at all. Out of compassion for beings he appears to eat, yet in every respect he is without fault.

Thus, Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress appears to engage in all the conduct of childish ordinary people, yet he engages in no conduct anywhere, no thorough conduct, no complete conduct, for he has turned away from all conduct. Dṛḍhamati, this should be seen as the particular way in which the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress purifies the path of deliverance of the perfection of meditative concentration.

Moreover, Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress appears to dwell in the wilderness, yet for him the village is just as the wilderness is. He appears to wear white clothes and live in a household, yet for him going forth is just as the household is. Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva is not stained by the ways of the household, nor is he conceited about the ways of one who has gone forth.

In order to bring beings to maturity, he appears to go forth among all the non-Buddhist sects, yet he never comes to hold the views of those sects at all, nor does he believe in purification through them. He displays the colors, forms, and emblems of all those sects, yet he does not enter into them, does not incline toward them, does not tend toward them, and does not arrive at them.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this: for example, a caravan leader who points out the road and guides a great caravan shows the way, travels that very road himself, and then turns back again to bring other great caravans across as well.

Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress shows the path to countless beings, whatever vehicle's path they stand on. To beings on the path of the śrāvaka vehicle he shows the path of the śrāvaka vehicle. To beings on the path of the pratyekabuddha vehicle he shows the path of the pratyekabuddha vehicle. To beings on the path of the buddha vehicle he shows the path of the Great Vehicle. Having shown each of those who are to go forth to deliverance the path that suits them, he turns back and ferries other beings across as well. That is why that holy being is called "like a guide who points out the path."

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this: a well-built boat goes from the near shore to the far shore in order to carry countless beings across. Having carried them over, it comes back again from the far shore to the near shore in order to carry other beings across. Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, the bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress sees beings who live in the stream of saṃsāra, swept along by the four floods. In order to carry them out of the stream of saṃsāra, he shows nirvāṇa to those beings in keeping with their inclinations. If that bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress sees beings who are to be trained through the śrāvaka vehicle, then in order to bring them to complete nirvāṇa he too passes into complete nirvāṇa together with them. Then, by bringing forth the power of this very samādhi of heroic progress, he shows himself being born once more. If he sees beings who are to be trained

through the pratyekabuddha vehicle, then in order to bring them to complete nirvāṇa he too passes into complete nirvāṇa together with them. Then, by bringing forth the power of this very samādhi of heroic progress, he shows himself being born once more. He goes from saṃsāra into nirvāṇa, and in order to carry other beings across he appears again in saṃsāra. Such persons are called "like a ferryboat."

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this: before a great crowd of people, a magician shows himself dying. He makes it appear that he has been burned, or eaten, or has rotted, or dried up, or been scattered to pieces. Having taken money from those people, he then sits up again. Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, the bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress shows birth, aging, sickness, and death in order to bring beings to maturity, yet for him there is no birth, no aging, no sickness, and no death. Dṛḍhamati, this too should be seen as a particular way in which the bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress refines his samādhi.

Furthermore, Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress is endowed with wisdom. Because his wisdom is sharp, he does not apprehend any intrinsic nature of sentient beings, yet in order to bring beings to maturity he uses the conventional term "being, being." He does not apprehend any intrinsic nature of a life-principle or a person, yet he makes use of the conventional designations "life-principle" and "person." He does not apprehend any intrinsic nature of karma and its ripening, yet he teaches karma and its ripening. He does not apprehend any intrinsic nature of the afflictions of saṃsāra, yet he teaches the full understanding of the afflictions of saṃsāra. He does not let go of passing into nirvāṇa, yet he teaches the Dharma so that others may pass into nirvāṇa. He does not apprehend any designation of phenomena, yet he teaches the classification of virtuous and nonvirtuous phenomena.

Through the unobstructed, supreme perfection of wisdom, he is not attached to the desire realm, yet he appears there. He is not attached to the form realm, yet he appears there. He appears absorbed in the meditative concentrations of the form realm, yet he is born in the desire realm. He appears absorbed in the absorptions of the formless realm, yet he is born in the form realm. He appears to be engaged in activity in the desire realm, yet he enters the absorption of the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception, and he is born in the desire realm. He knows the meditative concentrations and the factors of concentration, he settles into equipoise and

rises from it, and in order to bring beings to maturity he takes birth wherever he wishes.

Embraced by skillful means and wisdom, he abides in the turning away from all activity, yet he also acts in order to bring beings to maturity. He makes use of no phenomenon whatsoever, yet he has not turned away from any activity. He is free of grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine," yet he appears to take and to give. Because he is endowed with wisdom and gnosis, he performs all actions as actions done by gnosis, not out of pride, and they are not spoken of as karma and its ripening.

In order to bring beings to maturity, he appears mute like a sheep, dull, foolish, and deaf, yet he possesses the voice of Brahmā, eloquent speech, and a melodious tone. He has mastered every craft, and through the perfection of wisdom he does not think, "What shall I explain?" He does not wonder, "What shall I say?" Nor does he search for "How should I teach?" Whatever assembly he goes to, there it arises spontaneously. Through the might of the samādhi of heroic progress he knows the higher and lower faculties of every assembly, and so he speaks the Dharma with eloquence. His gnosis neither diminishes nor fills up, and he satisfies every assembly with his excellent explanations.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this: a woman, a man, a boy, or a girl takes a vessel, whether small or large, of whatever size, and goes to a spring, a pond, a pool, a lake, a river, or the great ocean. Though they fill all those vessels completely and go away, the spring, pond, pool, lake, river, or great ocean does not diminish in the slightest, and it satisfies those beings.

Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, whatever assembly a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) goes to, whether an assembly of kṣatriyas, an assembly of brahmins, an assembly of householders, an assembly of śramaṇas, an assembly of Śakra (Indra), or an assembly of Brahmā, he spontaneously satisfies them all with his excellent explanations. However he may teach the Dharma, in accordance with their lineage, faculties and inclinations, that bodhisattva's wisdom, primordial wisdom, eloquence and teaching do not diminish in the least, and he satisfies all the assemblies with his excellent explanations.

Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress tames sentient beings the very moment he is seen. He also tames sentient beings by being heard of, by his deportment, by his explanations, and even by remaining silent.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. For example, the great king of medicines called Lovely to Behold dispels the illnesses of sentient beings the very moment it is seen. Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress, the very moment he is seen, dispels the illnesses of those sentient beings, namely the illnesses of attachment, aversion and delusion.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. For example, if a great drum smeared with the great king of medicines called Separation is beaten at the edge of a battle, then the very moment beings hear the sound of that drum, their arrows fall out, and all poisons become harmless. Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, the very moment beings hear the name of a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress, the arrows of the afflictions of attachment, aversion and delusion fall out of them, and all the poisons of wrong views become harmless.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. For example, a medicinal tree dispels the illnesses of sentient beings even when taken from its roots. Even when taken from its trunk, its branches, its leaves, its flowers, its fruit, its bark, its sapwood or its heartwood, it dispels the illnesses of sentient beings. Even when taken from it standing upright, fallen down, or cut into pieces, it dispels the illnesses of sentient beings. Dṛḍhamati, thus a medicinal tree never fails to serve as a means of life that pacifies the illnesses of sentient beings.

Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress never fails to serve as a means of life that pacifies the illness of sentient beings' afflictions. He becomes a sustenance for those who help him and for those who harm him alike; he becomes a sustenance for those who honor him and for those who do not honor him alike. When he has died and passed away, the beings born in animal wombs who eat his flesh, bipeds and quadrupeds, wild beasts and flocks of birds, by the power produced by that bodhisattva's past aspirations and moral discipline, will, when they come to die, be born among the gods in the world of the higher realms, the happy destinies, the very moment they pass away; and they will be free from the lower realms and from illnesses. Dṛḍhamati, thus what is called a medicinal tree is a designation for a bodhisattva who abides in the samādhi of heroic progress.

Dṛḍhamati, for a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress, these six perfections operate constantly in all his lives without being taught to him. These six perfections operate in every step he takes as well. These six perfections operate in every breath he draws in and lets out as well. These six

perfections operate in each and every arising of thought as well. Why is that? Because, Dṛḍhamati, that bodhisattva's body is of the nature of the Dharma, and his abiding is of the nature of the Dharma.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. For example, suppose a king or a minister has prepared a compound of incense powder with a hundred thousand ingredients, ground as fine as dust, and some man comes and says, "O lord, from this compound of incense powders I wish to take a single ingredient that has not been mingled with the other incenses and is not mixed with the other incenses." Dṛḍhamati, what do you think? Could he take from that compound of incense powder a single ingredient that has not been mingled with the other incenses and is not mixed with the other incenses?

He replied, "Blessed One, he could not."

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, in the same way, that bodhisattva's body has long been perfumed by all the perfections, and his mind and all his mental factors arise perfumed by all the perfections. In each and every arising of his thought, the six perfections arise.

"Dṛḍhamati, if one asks how the six perfections arise in every arising of that bodhisattva's thought: Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. Whatever in his mind is letting go, renouncing and not clinging, that is his perfection of generosity. Whatever in his mind is peaceful, thoroughly peaceful, closely peaceful and has become utterly calm, that is his perfection of moral discipline. The inexhaustible nature of his mind and its not being harmed by any object, that is his perfection of patience. The mind's striving, its distinguishing, its seclusion and its discerning, that is his perfection of diligence. The mind's definite reflection, its close examination, and whatever is its thorough reflection, that is the perfection of meditative concentration. The mind's full knowing, its individual discernment, its being thoroughly peaceful, its being closely peaceful and its knowing directly, that is his perfection of wisdom."

"Thus, Dṛḍhamati, for a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama), through this way of entry the six perfections are present in every thought he generates."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Dṛḍhamati, said this to the Blessed One (the Buddha): "Blessed One, how inconceivable and how wondrous is the abiding of a bodhisattva who has fully perfected this samādhi of heroic progress! Blessed One, a bodhisattva who wishes to abide in the abiding of the Tathāgata should strive in this samādhi of heroic progress. Why is that?

Because, being like this, he is present even in the abodes of all ordinary, childish beings, and yet he does not become attached to anything, does not become hostile, and does not become deluded."

Then the Brahmā called Supreme Loving-kindness said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, a bodhisattva who wishes to abide in the abiding of all ordinary, childish beings should train in this samādhi of heroic progress. Why is that? Because, being like this, he is present even in the abodes of all ordinary, childish beings, and yet he clings to nothing, is bound by nothing, does not become attached, does not become hostile, and does not become deluded."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the Brahmā Supreme Loving-kindness: "Excellent, excellent! Brahmā, it is so. It is just as you have said. A bodhisattva who wishes to abide in the abiding of all ordinary, childish beings should train in this samādhi of heroic progress, without conceit about any of the trainings."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva train so that he trains in this samādhi of heroic progress without conceit about any of the trainings?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva, the great being Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. A master of archery, or a student of archery, first learns to hit a cowhide. When he has become skilled at the cowhide, he learns to hit a wooden plank. When he has become skilled at the plank, he learns to hit a target. When he has become skilled at the target, he learns to hit a stick. When he has become skilled at the stick, he learns to hit a hundred hairs. When he has become skilled at a hundred hairs, he learns to hit ten hairs. When he has become skilled at ten hairs, he learns to hit a single hair. When he has become skilled at a single hair, he trains in hitting what is indicated by sound. When he has become skilled at what is indicated by sound, he hits without missing. When he hits without missing, his training in archery is complete. Then, if he wishes, even at night in pitch darkness, whenever humans or nonhumans make a sound, his arrow flies there of its own accord and never misses.

"In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, when a bodhisattva trains in this samādhi of heroic progress, he first trains in intention. When he has become skilled in intention, he enters upon application. When he has trained in application, he enters upon superior intention. When he has trained in superior intention, he enters upon great loving-kindness. When he has trained in great

loving-kindness, he enters upon great compassion. When he has trained in great compassion, he enters upon great joy. When he has trained in great joy, he enters upon great equanimity. When he has trained in great equanimity, he has trained in the four noble abidings of a bodhisattva. What are the four? Great loving-kindness, great compassion, great joy, and great equanimity.

"When he has trained in these four noble abidings of a bodhisattva, he trains in the five concordant superknowledges (abhijñās), which do not decline. When he has trained in the five concordant superknowledges that do not decline, the six perfections are complete. When the six perfections have become complete, he fully understands skill in means. When he fully understands skill in means, he abides in the second patience, the concordant patience. When he abides in the second patience, the concordant patience, he attains patience with the unborn nature of phenomena. When he possesses patience with the unborn nature of phenomena, the buddhas, the blessed ones, prophesy his unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. When the buddhas, the blessed ones, have prophesied his unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he enters the eighth ground. When he has entered the eighth ground, in the bodhisattva samādhi he sees the buddhas of the present standing face to face before him, and being endowed with that samādhi, he is never parted from seeing the buddhas. When he is never parted from seeing the buddhas, he attains the complete fulfillment and perfection of all the qualities of a buddha.

"Abiding in the complete fulfillment and perfection of all the qualities of a buddha, he brings into being the perfect array of a buddha field. Having taken up the array of a buddha field, he brings to completion an excellent birth, family and clan, and an excellent entry into the womb and renunciation. Having attained an excellent birth, family and clan, and an excellent entry into the womb and renunciation, he brings the ten grounds to completion. Abiding on the ten grounds, he receives empowerment from all the buddhas. Having received empowerment from all the buddhas, he attains all the samādhis of a bodhisattva. Having attained all the samādhis of a bodhisattva, he then afterward attains this samādhi of heroic progress."

The bodhisattva who has attained the samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) remains close to sentient beings through the deeds of a buddha, and yet he does not give up the nature of a bodhisattva. Dṛḍhamati, in this way, the bodhisattva who has trained in such qualities will attain this samādhi of heroic progress.

Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress no longer needs to train in anything at all. Why is that? Because he has trained well in the past, all the qualities of a buddha become manifest to him.

Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. An archery master, or a student of archery, who has become established in hitting a target by its sound alone, no longer trains in anything afterward. Why is that? Because he has trained well in the past, every target he is to strike becomes manifest to him. In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress no longer needs to train in any quality at all. Why is that? Because he has trained well in the past, all samādhis, all meditative attainments, all liberations, and all the virtuous qualities of a bodhisattva become manifest to him.

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I am inspired to speak! Sugata, I am inspired to speak!"

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, if you know that the time has come, speak as you are inspired."

Dṛḍhamati said, "Blessed One, it is like this. Great Brahmā, who holds sway over the great trichiliocosm, surveys this great trichiliocosm world system with little effort. In the same way, Blessed One, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress surveys all the qualities of a bodhisattva with little effort, and he also knows the minds and the conduct of all sentient beings."

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, it is so. It is just as you have said. Those bodhisattvas who abide in this samādhi of heroic progress have cast a gaze that surveys everything, and all the qualities of a buddha have become directly present to them."

Then a Śakra called Holder of the Summit of Meru, who dwelt on a continent at the edge of this great trichiliocosm world system, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, it is like this. One who stands on the summit of Mount Meru sees all its terraces with little effort. In the same way, Blessed One, a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress surveys with little effort all the conduct of the śrāvakas, and he also surveys all the conduct of the pratyekabuddhas, all the conduct of the bodhisattvas, and the conduct of all sentient beings."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru: "O friend, from which four-continent world system have you come here? On the summit of which Meru do you dwell?"

When he had said this, Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru said this to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Son of noble family, one does not ask a bodhisattva who has attained this samādhi of heroic progress where he dwells. Why is that? He dwells in all buddha fields. He does not dwell anywhere through attachment. He does not dwell through any object of reference. He does not dwell through views."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru: "O friend, have you attained this samādhi of heroic progress?"

Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru said, "Son of noble family, is this samādhi present through attainment, or through non-attainment?"

Dṛḍhamati said, "It is neither."

He said, "Son of noble family, therefore the bodhisattva who abides by means of this samādhi attains no phenomenon whatsoever, and there is no attainment."

The bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said, "O friend, judging from your eloquence, you abide in this samādhi of heroic progress."

He said, "Son of noble family, because all phenomena are without abode, I do not see any phenomenon in which one would abide in this samādhi of heroic progress. Why is that? A bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi does not abide in any phenomenon at all. Where there is no abiding in anything, there is no grasping. Where there is no grasping, there is no teaching of the Dharma whatsoever."

Then the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, do you see Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I see him."

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, this Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru has attained this samādhi of heroic progress. He has attained certainty. He has attained effortlessness. Abiding in the samādhi of heroic progress, he shows himself in every one of the abodes of Śakra that exist in this great trichiliocosm world system."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if this Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru is present in all the abodes of Śakra, I have never before seen him on the summit of Mount Meru, my own abode of Śakra."

Then Śakra Holder of the Summit of Meru said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, even if the complete form body of one such as I could be shown to one such as you, that would not make you present in all the abodes of Śakra. Kauśika, I do move about in your abode of Śakra, yet you do not see me."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we wish to see the complete form body of this holy being."

The Blessed One (the Buddha) said, "Kauśika, do you wish to see the perfected physical body of this holy being?"

Śakra replied, "Blessed One, I wish to see it."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Śakra called Holder of Meru's Summit: "Holy being, show your perfected physical body to Śakra, lord of the gods."

Then the Śakra called Holder of Meru's Summit showed his perfected physical body. The moment he showed it, the bodies of everyone in that assembly who had not attained this samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) appeared like heaps of ink. This held for the Śakras, the Brahmās, the world guardians, the gods of the Pure Abodes, the followers of the vehicle of the śrāvakas, the followers of the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, the followers of the vehicle of the bodhisattvas, and any other sentient beings besides. The body of that Śakra appeared towering like Mount Meru, blazing, brilliant and radiant. The body of the Tathāgata appeared to be twice his size.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, the perfected physical body of this great being is wondrous. Blessed One, the bodies of these Śakras, Brahmās and world guardians look like heaps of ink. Blessed One, when I am on the summit of Mount Meru, in Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods, I wear around my neck the great precious jewel called Śakrābhilagna. Its light makes the whole assembly of gods dim, so that they do not blaze, are not brilliant, are not radiant. Yet, Blessed One, the light of this holy being has made me dim, and even my great precious Śakrābhilagna jewel does not blaze, is not brilliant, is not radiant."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to Śakra, lord of the gods, "Kauśika, even if this great trichiliocosm were completely filled with great precious Śakrābhilagna jewels, there is a precious jewel called Illuminating All the Gods, and its light would make all those Śakrābhilagna jewels dim. Kauśika, even if this great trichiliocosm were completely filled with precious jewels Illuminating All the Gods, there is a precious jewel called Vajra

Radiance, and its light would make all those jewels Illuminating All the Gods dim. Kauśika, even if this great trichiliocosm were completely filled with precious Vajra Radiance jewels, there is a precious jewel called Gathering All Radiance, and it makes all the Vajra Radiance jewels dim. Kauśika, do you see that this Śakra wears around his neck the great precious jewel called Gathering All Radiance?"

"Blessed One, when I looked at it, my eyes were dazzled. Such is its light."

The Blessed One said, "Kauśika, a bodisattva who has attained this samādhi of heroic progress will, whenever he becomes Śakra, lord of the gods, wear such a precious jewel around his neck."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, those sentient beings who have not aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening are completely deprived of such a perfected physical body. Blessed One, those sentient beings are completely deprived of this samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the young god Gopaka, having heard what Śakra, lord of the gods, had said, spoke to him: "Father, what good does it do if many hundreds of beings who have entered the certainty of the śrāvakas give rise to a longing for the qualities of the Buddha? They have cut off the stream of saṃsāra. Father, it is those who have aroused the mind set on awakening, those who are arousing it, and those who will arouse it who should give rise to a longing for these qualities of the Buddha, for they will attain such a perfected physical body. Father, it is like this: however much the praises of the sun and moon are spoken and extolled, even if a man born blind gives rise to a longing for them, he does not see them and does not experience them. Father, in the same way, however much longing those who have entered the certainty of the śrāvakas give rise to when the praises of the qualities of the Buddha are spoken and taught, they do not know, see or experience the qualities and virtues of the Buddha. Therefore, Father, one who wants such form should arouse the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and then one's physical body will become perfected in color like this."

When the young god Gopaka gave this teaching, twelve thousand young gods aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the young god Gopaka, "Young god, by how great a root of virtue were you transformed from a woman's body?"

He replied, "Son of good family, for one who abides in the Great Vehicle, it is no fault whether one abides as a woman or as a man. Why is that? Because the mind of omniscience does not abide together with the three realms; woman and man are distinctions made by the mind. Further, son of good family, as to what you asked, 'By how great a root of virtue were you transformed from a woman's body?', it was by serving my husband without guile and with a cherishing mind."

Dṛḍhamati asked, "How did you serve your husband?"

He replied, "By cherishing him as I would the Teacher himself."

He asked, "How did you act without deceit?"

She replied, "As my bodily actions were and as my verbal actions were, so too I performed my mental actions. Son of good family, that is a woman's freedom from deceit."

He asked, "How were you transformed from a woman's body?"

He replied, "In just the way I accomplished it."

He asked, "How did you accomplish it?"

He replied, "In just the way I was transformed."

He asked, "Young god, what is the meaning of what you have said?"

He replied, "Son of good family, all phenomena are of one taste in the realm of reality (dharmadhātu). Therefore, son of good family, all phenomena are neither accomplished nor turned back. Moreover, son of good family, for as long as I made aspirations, for that long the characteristics of a woman appeared in me. And when the characteristics of a man appeared in me, even then I did not abandon that nature of reality which is the intrinsic nature of a woman. Therefore, son of good family, to grasp at anything as woman or as man is to grasp mistakenly. Son of good family, whatever is mistaken and whatever is unmistaken, the two are nondual and indivisible. Why is that? Son of good family, all phenomena are utterly free of duality."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the young god Gopaka, "Young god, has even some part of this samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) become directly evident to you?"

He replied, "Son of good family, it became evident to me through another's teaching, not through my own wisdom. Son of good family, I recall the time when the Blessed One Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly

complete Buddha, was a bodhisattva in the palace of King Śuddhodana and was staying in my bed in the inner chamber. Late in the night, when everyone was asleep, Brahmās as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River came from the east. There they questioned the bodhisattva thoroughly about the path of the bodhisattvas and the path of the śrāvakas, and the bodhisattva answered them in accordance with the questions they had asked. Then one Brahmā said to the bodhisattva, 'Holy being, you have attained such knowledge of the Dharma, such unobstructed wisdom and such eloquence, yet you are attached to sensual pleasures and to kingship. This is not fitting.'

Then the other Brahmās, to whom the qualities of the bodhisattva's knowledge of skillful means were directly evident, said, 'Son of good family, he does not dwell in a household for the sake of sensual pleasures and kingship. He dwells in a household in order to bring beings to maturity. He is also turning the wheel of Dharma in other world systems, and here too he appears as a bodhisattva.'

At that, the first Brahmā said, 'Abiding in what samādhi does a bodhisattva come to perform such miraculous displays?'

They replied, 'Brahmā, this is the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress.'

Son of good family, at that time I thought, 'Thus he fully enjoys sensual pleasures, he holds the kingdom, and he has also attained samādhi. How wonderful is the power of the bodhisattvas' samādhi!' Son of good family, having heard that, I firmly established the perception of the bodhisattva as truly the Teacher. Having also gained faith, with superior intention I generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, saying, 'May I too come to possess such wisdom and such qualities.' Son of good family, only a mere part of this became evident to me; the particular qualities of this samādhi of heroic progress are inconceivable."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the Blessed One (the Buddha), "Blessed One, the superior intention shown by the young god Gopaka is wonderful. Because he has been embraced by the spiritual friend, the Blessed One, just as the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha now performs miraculous displays, so too, Blessed One, this young god Gopaka will before long abide in this samādhi of heroic progress and perform miraculous displays."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, so it is."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, are there any bodhisattvas gathered in this assembly who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress?"

Now in that assembly a young god called Manifest Buddha Intellect was present. Seated there, he said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Dṛḍhamati, you are seated before the Tathāgata, a great ocean of wisdom, and you have come among bodhisattva great beings who possess infinite jewels of qualities and who have donned the great armor. When I consider your question, 'Blessed One, are there any bodhisattvas gathered in this assembly who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress?', I think it is like some childish ship's captain who, having entered the great ocean, says, 'Are there any jewels in this great ocean that I could take and carry away?'

Dṛḍhamati, in this assembly there are bodhisattvas who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress who have the color and form of Śakra (Indra). There are bodhisattvas who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress who have the color and form of Brahmā. There are bodhisattvas who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress who have the color and form of gods. There are bodhisattvas who have the color and form of wheel-turning monarchs. There are bodhisattvas who have the color and form of monks. There are bodhisattvas who have the color and form of nuns. There are bodhisattvas who have the color and form of laymen. And there are those who have the color and form of laywomen."

There are also those who are beautifully adorned with the major marks. There are also bodhisattvas who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) who, in order to tame sentient beings, have lowly bodies and complexions.

Dṛḍhamati, in this assembly there are also bodhisattvas who have the complexion, form, and deportment of śrāvakas. There are also bodhisattvas who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress who have the complexion, form, and deportment of pratyekabuddhas.

Dṛḍhamati, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha, may go to an assembly of kṣatriyas, an assembly of brahmins, an assembly of householders, an assembly of śramaṇas, an assembly of gods, an assembly of Śakra (Indra), an assembly of Brahmā, or an assembly of the world guardians. Whatever assembly he goes to, the Tathāgata appears in a complexion, form, and deportment that matches the inclinations of those beings, and they too

see his complexion as being just like their own. Dṛḍhamati, that too should be regarded as a particular result of having trained the intention in the samādhi of heroic progress in the past.

Dṛḍhamati, wherever you see a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly awakened Buddha, teaching the Dharma, know that there are, right there, countless bodhisattva great beings who have donned the great armor, who abide in mastery over all phenomena, and who turn the wheel of Dharma.

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, judging from this one's eloquence, from the way he explains with unobstructed wisdom, and from the way he explains the analysis of conduct, I think that this young god Manifest Buddha Intellect has attained this samādhi of heroic progress."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, so it is. It is just as you have said. This young god abides in the samādhi of heroic progress, and he teaches having actualized this samādhi."

Then the Blessed One said to the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect, "Young god, show some aspect of the particular results of training in this samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect said this to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, would you like to see just a portion of the supreme excellence of this samādhi of heroic progress?"

He replied, "Young god, I would like to see it."

Then the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect, because he had attained this samādhi of heroic progress, at that moment displayed a sign by bringing about a miracle such that this entire assembly perceived itself as abiding in the complexion and form of universal monarchs, beautifully adorned with the major marks, accompanied by retinues, endowed with the might of armies, and possessed of the seven precious things. He then said, "Dṛḍhamati, what do you see?"

He replied, "Young god, I see this entire assembly abiding in the complexion, shape, and form of universal monarchs, beautifully adorned with the major marks, accompanied by retinues, endowed with the might of armies, and possessed of the seven precious things."

Then the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect, by his blessing, brought about a miracle such that the entire assembly perceived itself as abiding in the complexion, shape, and form of Śakra, lord of the gods, dwelling in the mansions of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, surrounded by a hundred thousand goddesses, and making the sounds of cymbals, clapping, and music. He then said, "Dṛḍhamati, what do you see?"

He replied, "Young god, I see this entire assembly abiding in the complexion, shape, and form of Śakra, lord of the gods, dwelling in the divine mansions of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, surrounded by a hundred thousand goddesses, and making the sounds of cymbals, clapping, and music."

Then the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect again, by his blessing, brought about such a blessing that the entire assembly perceived itself as abiding in the complexion, shape, and form of Brahmā, with utterly peaceful deportment, dwelling in the celestial palace of Brahmā's abode, and meditating in the concentration of the four immeasurables. He then said, "Dṛḍhamati, what do you see?"

He replied, "Young god, I see this entire assembly abiding in the complexion, shape, and form of Brahmā, with perfectly peaceful deportment, dwelling in the celestial palace of Brahmā's abode, and meditating in the concentration of the four immeasurables."

Then the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect again, by his blessing, brought about such a blessing that those assemblies appeared just like the elder Mahākāśyapa: his complexion, form, and shape, his deportment of wearing the patched robe and the lower robe and carrying the alms bowl, and his meditation in the concentration of the eight liberations. They appeared without any variety, all of a single complexion. He then said, "Dṛḍhamati, what do you see?"

He replied, "Young god, I see this entire assembly appearing just like the elder Mahākāśyapa: his complexion, form, and shape, his deportment of wearing the patched robe and the lower robe and carrying the alms bowl, and his meditation in the concentration of the eight liberations. I see them like that, without any variety, all of a single complexion."

Then the young god Manifest Buddha Intellect, in order to show the supreme excellence of this very samādhi of heroic progress, made the entire assembly in the complexion, form, shape, and deportment of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, adorned with the array of the major marks, and

And just as he was surrounded by his saṅgha of attendant monks, so the many tathāgatas each appeared together with a saṅgha of monks. Having displayed such a sign, he said, "Dṛḍhamati, what do you see?"

Dṛḍhamati said, "Young god, I see this entire assembly adorned with the Tathāgata's color, form, shape, deportment and array of major marks. And just as he is surrounded by his saṅgha of attendant monks, so I see each of them accompanied by a saṅgha of monks."

He said, "Dṛḍhamati, this is the lordly excellence of the samādhi of heroic progress. Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva who possesses that samādhi can, if he wishes, transform this great trichiliocosm, this world system of three thousand worlds, into a single mustard seed. Or else he shows it wholly contained within a single mustard seed, and all its four-continent world systems still appear, and all its suns and moons still appear, and no harm comes to the beings in it. Dṛḍhamati, in this way this samādhi is inconceivable."

The third fascicle.

Then the great śrāvakas, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans, Śakra, Brahmā and the world guardians, and the bodhisattvas spoke with one voice:

"Blessed One, the bodhisattvas who have attained or will attain this samādhi of heroic progress should be regarded as inconceivable. Blessed One, those beings proceed with the gait of the Tathāgata. They possess the wisdom of the superknowledges and the higher knowledges. Blessed One, while we remained on our one seat we took on such color and form as this, and we saw one another with such color, form and deportment. Blessed One, we think: those beings whose ears the samādhi of heroic progress does not reach are under the sway of Māra. Blessed One, even beings who merely hear this samādhi of heroic progress are embraced by all the buddhas, so what need is there to speak of those who recite it? What need to speak of those who, having heard it, practice it earnestly? What need to speak of those who hear this samādhi of heroic progress?

"Blessed One, wishing to reach the far shore of all dharmas, we will listen to the samādhi of heroic progress. We will retain it. We will read it. We will master it completely. Wishing to display every form and color, wishing to display the conduct and deportment of all beings just as they are, wishing to understand their minds fully, and wishing to cure their illnesses with the

medicine suited to each, we will listen to this very samādhi of heroic progress. We will read it. We will cultivate it. Those holy beings who have attained this samādhi of heroic progress dwell in the domain of all the buddhas. They have mastery over self-arisen wisdom."

When they had said this, the Blessed One spoke as follows to the great śrāvakas, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, to Śakra, Brahmā and the world guardians, and to the bodhisattvas:

"Sons of good family, it is so. It is just as you have said. Since he has not attained this samādhi of heroic progress, I do not call that bodhisattva a bodhisattva. Since he has not attained this samādhi of heroic progress, I do not say of that bodhisattva that he has attained the superknowledges. Since he has not attained this samādhi of heroic progress, I do not say of that bodhisattva that he has completed his training. Since he has not attained this samādhi of heroic progress, I do not say of that bodhisattva that he possesses generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, wisdom and skillful means. Since he has not attained this samādhi of heroic progress, I do not say of that bodhisattva that he is learned. Since he has not attained this samādhi of heroic progress, I do not say of that bodhisattva that he is endowed with eloquence. Therefore, sons of good family, a bodhisattva who wishes to go forth by every path of going forth should train in this samādhi of heroic progress, so as to be free of all conceit."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence, "Young god, in what should a bodhisattva who wishes to attain this samādhi exert himself?"

He replied, "Son of good family, a bodhisattva who wishes to attain this samādhi should exert himself in the dharmas of ordinary beings."

Dṛḍhamati asked, "Young god, how should a bodhisattva exert himself in the dharmas of ordinary beings?"

He replied, "Son of good family, a bodhisattva should exert himself in the dharmas of ordinary beings in such a way that he sees the dharmas of ordinary beings as neither joined with the dharmas of the buddhas nor separate from them."

Dṛḍhamati asked, "Young god, do the dharmas of the buddhas, then, abide as joined or as not joined?"

He replied, "Son of good family, the dharmas of ordinary beings too cannot be joined or separated. Son of good family, the dharmas of the buddhas and the dharmas of ordinary beings are not two and cannot be divided into two, for they are of a single mode. Therefore, son of good family, though this is called exertion, there is no dharma whatsoever here to be joined or separated. And why is that? Son of good family, all dharmas possess the suchness of non-arising. All dharmas possess the suchness of non-cessation. All dharmas possess the suchness of non-disturbance."

All phenomena possess the suchness of non-gathering. All phenomena possess the suchness of non-separation. All phenomena possess solitude, like space. All phenomena possess the sameness of emptiness. All phenomena possess the unborn nature of reality, and so there is no death and transmigration.

He asked, "Young god, where does the samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) go?"

He answered, "Son of good family, the samādhi of heroic progress goes to the minds and conduct of all sentient beings, yet it does not go to mind, to views, or to perceiving objects as referents. It goes into every death, transmigration and birth of those who go through existence, yet it does not go into the afflictions of those who go through existence. Son of good family, the samādhi of heroic progress goes to the display of all samādhis, yet it does not go to the disturbance of sameness. It goes to the entering of all buddha fields, yet it does not go to the perception of fields as various. It goes to the display of all buddhas, yet it does not go to conceptualizing and displaying the form and the major marks of the buddhas. It goes to the display of all sounds and languages, yet it does not go to the conceptualization of the perception of letters. Son of good family, the samādhi of heroic progress goes to the seeing of all buddhas, yet it does not go to a thorough seeing. Therefore, son of good family, as to what was asked, 'How does the samādhi of heroic progress go?': whatever is the going of the Tathāgata, that is also the going of this samādhi."

He asked, "Young god, how does the Tathāgata go?"

He answered, "Because of suchness, the Tathāgata goes by not going."

He asked, "Young god, does the Tathāgata not go into parinirvāṇa?"

He answered, "Son of good family, all phenomena go into parinirvāṇa; therefore the Tathāgata does not go into parinirvāṇa. Why is that? Because

the going of nirvāṇa does not pass into parinirvāṇa."

He asked, "Young god, have not buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges passed into parinirvāṇa?"

He answered, "Son of good family, have buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges been born?"

He said, "Young god, the Tathāgata has declared that buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges were born and also passed into nirvāṇa."

He answered, "Son of good family, the Tathāgata also declared: 'For the benefit of many people, gods and humans, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, for the sake of the great multitude of gods and humans, for their benefit and for their happiness, one person arises in the world, namely the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha.' Did the Tathāgata find any such person who is born or who ceases?"

He said, "Young god, the Tathāgata did not find any phenomenon whatsoever that is born or that ceases."

He answered, "Son of good family, just so. Although the Tathāgata speaks of a buddha arising, the nature of reality of the Tathāgata has no arising or cessation. Although the Tathāgata speaks of a buddha passing into parinirvāṇa, the suchness of the Tathāgata does not pass into parinirvāṇa."

He asked, "Young god, are not countless tathāgatas even now attaining manifest and perfect awakening?"

He answered, "Son of good family, just as the nature of non-arising is, and just as the nature of non-cessation is, so the Tathāgata is born and attains manifest and perfect awakening. Son of good family, I do not hold the Tathāgata's manifest and perfect awakening and his parinirvāṇa to be different."

He asked, "Why?"

He answered, "Son of good family, the Tathāgata awakened manifestly and perfectly to all phenomena as utterly and completely passed into nirvāṇa."

He asked, "Young god, can one awaken manifestly and perfectly to a phenomenon that has utterly and completely passed into nirvāṇa?"

He answered, "Son of good family, just as it has completely passed into nirvāṇa, so he awakens manifestly and perfectly to it, yet he does not pass

beyond that suchness of nirvāṇa. Son of good family, the Tathāgata did not attain manifest and perfect awakening through birth, nor through cessation, nor through abiding in any phenomenon whatsoever. Son of good family, where there is no birth, no cessation and no abiding, that is complete nirvāṇa."

He asked, "Young god, do you abide in this samādhi of heroic progress and teach in this way?"

He answered, "Son of good family, I do not teach while abiding in any phenomenon whatsoever."

He asked, "Young god, how do you teach while abiding in non-abiding?"

He answered, "Son of good family, what do you think? When an emanation emanated by the Tathāgata teaches, where does it abide as it teaches?"

He said, "That emanation of the Tathāgata teaches through the Tathāgata's blessing."

He asked, "Son of good family, then with what blessing does the Tathāgata bless when he blesses the emanation? Does he bless a self?"

He said, "No, he does not."

He asked, "Does he bless something other?"

He said, "No, he does not."

He asked, "Does he bless the teaching of the Dharma?"

He said, "No, he does not."

He asked, "Then where does the Tathāgata abide as he blesses?"

He answered, "Young god, the Tathāgata abides in non-abiding and emanates emanations."

He said, "Son of good family, just as the Tathāgata abides in non-abiding and emanates emanations, so too those emanations teach while abiding in non-abiding. Son of good family, in the same way all phenomena abide in non-abiding, and I too abide in non-abiding and teach this samādhi."

He asked, "Young god, if you abide in non-abiding, how do you come to be eloquent?"

He answered, "Just as there is non-abiding, so am I eloquent."

He asked, "Young god, in what way does a bodhisattva have perfect eloquence?"

He replied, "Son of good family, a bodhisattva who does not teach with the perception of a self, and does not teach with the perception of a person, the perception of a sentient being, or the perception of phenomena, such a bodhisattva, son of good family, has perfect eloquence. When he teaches the Dharma, just as letters are inexhaustible and never become exhausted, so the Dharma is inexhaustible and never becomes exhausted. He does not teach letters as being of various kinds, nor does he teach phenomena as being of various kinds. Son of good family, it is in this way that a bodhisattva has perfect eloquence.

"Furthermore, son of good family, when a bodhisattva does not abandon the nature of reality, which is that the mind is an illusion, does not abandon the nature of reality, which is freedom from attachment, and does not abandon the nature of reality, which is like an echo, such, son of good family, is a bodhisattva's perfect eloquence. Just as those letters do not abide in an object, do not abide in a direction, are not inside, are not outside, are not without both, and do not abide anywhere at all, but arise from a coming together of conditions, so too, son of good family, all phenomena do not abide in an object, do not abide in a direction, are not inside, are not outside, are not without both, are not past, are not future, and are not present. And the letters by which they are explained are likewise. Because he teaches with these inexhaustible letters made directly manifest, it is therefore called perfect eloquence."

He asked, "Young god, are you eloquent in the very way you teach?"

He replied, "Son of good family, I am eloquent in just that way. Just as is the nature of an echo's arising, so too should everything explained through the sound of the path be understood."

He asked, "Young god, what is meant by 'understanding'?"

He replied, "Son of good family, 'understanding' is a designation for understanding space. Son of good family, it is like this: space, for example, has no analogy. Son of good family, in the same way all phenomena too have no analogy, and therefore it is called understanding. Since it is not easy to make an analogy even for those phenomena into which it enters, it is therefore called understanding. Because that wisdom understands what has no analogy, what has no likeness, what is free of all entities, it is therefore called understanding."

Then the Blessed One, the Buddha, applauded the young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence, saying, "Excellent! Young god, excellent, excellent! These words of yours are well spoken. If one is to explain, one explains in just this way. A bodhisattva, on hearing this explanation, should not be frightened, should not be terrified, should not become terrified. Why is that? Because without understanding what is to be understood, one cannot fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, from which buddha field has this young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence come here to this Sahā world?"

The young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence said, "Son of good family, what is the purpose of asking?"

He replied, "Young god, I bow toward any direction where there is a temple, a dwelling, an abode, or a walking place of such holy beings as these. Homage should be paid there."

The young god said, "Dṛḍhamati, those sentient beings into whose hands this very teaching on the samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama) comes, having been written down in a book, they too are worthy of homage from the world with its gods."

Then the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, this young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence has come to this Sahā world from the world Abhirati, the buddha field of the Tathāgata Akṣobhya, in order to hear and to teach this samādhi of heroic progress."

He asked, "Blessed One, does the Tathāgata Akṣobhya not teach this samādhi of heroic progress to those bodhisattvas? Why is it that this young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence has come from that world Abhirati to this Sahā world?"

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, a tathāgata who does not teach this samādhi is extremely rare indeed. But, Dṛḍhamati, this young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence will fully awaken to awakening in this Sahā world. This young god has come from that world Abhirati to this Sahā world in order to overcome whatever faults of the five degenerations there are in this Sahā world, to take up the arrayed qualities of a buddha field, to bring sentient beings to maturity, and to bring to perfection the thorough cultivation of this samādhi of heroic progress."

He asked, "Blessed One, when will this young god Manifest Buddha Intelligence fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in this Sahā world? Once he has attained awakening, what will his name be? Blessed One, at that time, what will this world be called?"

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, after this Fortunate Eon has passed and its thousand buddhas have entered complete nirvāṇa, for sixty-two eons a buddha will appear; during that time a hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of pratyekabuddhas will also appear. Dṛḍhamati, after those sixty-two eons have passed, that young god will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and will become the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King Renowned for Stainless Light.

"Dṛḍhamati, at that time this Sahā world will become a world called Inspiring Faith on Sight. Dṛḍhamati, in that world called Inspiring Faith on Sight, the buddha field of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, all the beings will be beautiful because they have gained faith. No being there will dwell with a mind entangled by attachment, none with a mind entangled by aversion, and none with a mind entangled by delusion. All those beings will be devoted to the practice of the Dharma and will gain faith in the Dharma.

"Dṛḍhamati, the lifespan of the Tathāgata King Renowned for Stainless Light will be ten intermediate eons. Beings will reach deliverance by means of the three vehicles. The bodhisattvas there who have attained the samādhi of heroic progress and who have mastery of transformation over all phenomena will be beyond measure.

"Dṛḍhamati, at that time, whatever māras and gods of Māra's class appear will all have entered the Great Vehicle completely, and they will dwell in compassion toward all beings. That buddha field will be entirely free of the three lower realms. It will be beyond the eight unfavorable states, a buddha field always adorned, like the northern continent of Uttarakuru. That buddha field will be one where the māras and adversaries have been defeated, and it will be free of all wrong views.

"After the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King Renowned for Stainless Light, has passed into complete nirvāṇa, the true Dharma taught by that Sugata will remain for a hundred thousand times ten million years.

"Dṛḍhamati, this young god will, with such arrays as these, fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in this Sahā world."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the young god Manifest Buddha Mind, "Young god, since the Tathāgata has prophesied your unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, you have gained a great gain indeed."

The young god said, "Son of noble family, the non-gaining of all phenomena is the gain of the Dharma. For whoever apprehends any phenomenon at all, there is no gain of the Dharma whatsoever. Therefore, son of noble family, the non-gaining of all phenomena, their individual non-gaining and their non-apprehension, is the gain of the Dharma. Son of noble family, I too have gained a fine gain."

When this was explained and expounded to that young god, twenty-five thousand living beings who had previously cultivated roots of virtue set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and ten thousand bodhisattvas attained forbearance toward the non-arising of phenomena.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, it is wonderful that while this samādhi of heroic progress is being taught, Māra the Evil One does not come to cause interference. Sugata, it is wonderful."

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, do you wish to see Māra the Evil One right now?"

He replied, "I do wish to, Blessed One."

Then at that moment the Blessed One sent forth from the ūrṇā hair between his brows a light of such a kind that the whole assembly saw Māra the Evil One bound with fivefold bonds, unable to cut those bonds or free himself from them. The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, do you see Māra the Evil One bound with fivefold bonds?"

He replied, "I see him, Blessed One. I see him, Sugata."

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, that is the supreme might of this samādhi of heroic progress. Śāriputra, in whatever buddha fields this samādhi of heroic progress is explained or taught, any māras or gods of Māra's class there, whose minds are full of hatred and who draw near in order to obstruct the Dharma, will all, through the splendor of the samādhi of heroic progress and the blessing of those buddhas, the blessed ones, find themselves bound with fivefold bonds. Śāriputra, whether now or after I have passed into complete nirvāṇa, wherever this samādhi of heroic progress is explained, taught, written down or made into a book, Māra the Evil One, or the gods of Māra's class, or any others whatsoever whose thoughts are full of hatred, will all, through the

splendor of the samādhi of heroic progress and the blessing of those buddhas, the blessed ones, find themselves bound with fivefold bonds."

Then all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans gathered in that assembly said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, we have no doubt about this samādhi of heroic progress. We have no hesitation, and we will not obstruct it. We do not wish to be bound. Blessed One, in order to uphold this samādhi, we will also protect the preacher of the Dharma. We will regard this samādhi of heroic progress as the Teacher."

When they had said this, the Blessed One spoke to those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans as follows:

"O friends, therefore free yourselves completely from the twelve bonds of views. What are the twelve? They are the bond of the view of a self, the bond of the view of a sentient being, the bond of the view of a life-principle, the bond of the view of a person, the bond of the view of annihilation, the bond of the view of permanence, the bond of the view that grasps at an 'I', the bond of the view that grasps at a 'mine', the bond of the view of arising, the bond of the view of destruction, the bond of the view of the perishable collection, and the bond of the view that clings to all phenomena.

"O friends, all those who revile, reject, or turn away from the Tathāgata, or from the Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata, do so because they are bound by these twelve bonds. Bound by them, they turn away, they reject, they revile. O friends, all those who hear this Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata, have faith in it and trust it, and do not reject it, will be completely freed from these twelve bonds of views."

Then the elder Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, has Māra the Evil One heard the name of this samādhi of heroic progress?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, he has heard it, but he is unable to come and free himself from that bondage."

Śāriputra said, "Blessed One, it is wonderful that when the Tathāgata blesses the name of this samādhi of heroic progress, it comes to be heard. Blessed One, it is wonderful! Sugata, it is wonderful!"

The Blessed One said, "Enough, Śāriputra, do not say that. Śāriputra, even if buddha fields as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges were completely

filled with fire, one should push through them and go to hear the name of this samādhi of heroic progress. Why is that? Śāriputra, I have taught that this samādhi of heroic progress, once heard, is something to be cherished, and that abiding in the four meditative concentrations and being born in the world of Brahmā is not like this.

"Śāriputra, the very fact that Māra the Evil One has heard the name of this samādhi of heroic progress will become the cause for all his māra-deeds to be completely pacified. Whoever hears it even while bound by bonds, that very hearing will become the cause of his complete liberation from the twelve bonds of views. Therefore, Śāriputra, if even one who remains bound by Māra's noose of views should listen to this samādhi of heroic progress, what need is there to mention those who listen to it having attained joy, faith, and supreme delight?"

Then a bodhisattva called Māragocarānupalipta, Untainted by the Domain of Māra's Activity, came to that assembly and sat down. The bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta then said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please have Māra the Evil One come to this assembly. Blessed One, I will show him all the domains of Māra's activity, and I will lead him into this samādhi of heroic progress as well."

The Blessed One said, "Now, if you think the time has come for it, do so."

Then the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta vanished from that assembly and appeared in Māra's abode. The bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta then said to Māra the Evil One, "Evil One, when the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha teaches the samādhi of heroic progress, will you not listen? There, immeasurable sentient beings are putting on the armor for the sake of awakening, and they will pass beyond your domain. Moreover, sentient beings utterly beyond measure will pass beyond your domain."

When he had said this, Māra the Evil One said to the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta, "Noble son, I am unable to come to listen to the samādhi of heroic progress. Why is that? I am bound by the five bonds of a noose. Because I am bound at my two hands, my two feet, and my neck, I cannot go there."

The bodhisattva said, "Evil One, who bound you?"

Māra said, "When I thought, 'I will go and obstruct this samādhi, and I will separate from it those sentient beings who have faith in it,' at that moment I

found myself bound by the five bonds of the noose. When I think, 'The Tathāgata is hard to please, and those properly set out in the Great Vehicle are also hard to please, so I will not go there but will stay right here in my own abode,' at that moment I find myself freed."

The bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta said, "Evil One, just so, all childish ordinary beings are bound by the distortions of their own imaginings. They are bound by grasping at perceptions. They are bound by agitation, by conceit, and by conceptual elaboration. They are bound by the conceptual thought of seeing, hearing, distinguishing, and cognizing. Yet, Evil One, here no phenomenon whatsoever is bound, and none is freed. Why is that? Evil One, because all phenomena are by their intrinsic nature completely liberated, all phenomena are free. Evil One, all phenomena are by their intrinsic nature neither bound nor freed. Evil One, this is the Dharma door called the door of neither bound nor freed, and the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma through that door. Those who understand this teaching of the Dharma do not strive to be freed from bondage, nor do they apprehend any bondage from which they would be freed."

Then seven hundred goddesses from within that assembly scattered divine flowers, incense, powders, perfumes, garlands, and ointments over the body of the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta and asked, "Noble son, when will one be freed from these bonds of Māra?"

That noble son said to them, "Whoever does not stir up the bonds of Māra will be freed from the bonds of Māra. What are those bonds of Māra? They are the sixty-two views. Whoever does not stir up the sixty-two views will be freed from the bonds of Māra."

Those young goddesses asked, "Son of noble family, how is it that views are not stirred up?"

He replied, "Those views have not entered into any phenomenon, nor have they failed to enter. In this way they go nowhere and come from nowhere, and this is liberation from the bonds of Māra. Those views are nonexistent; they do not exist. Whoever does not conceptualize existence and nonexistence is liberated from the bonds of Māra. None of those views is established, and the non-establishment of all phenomena is liberation from the bonds of Māra. Those views are not inside, nor are they outside, nor are they found apart from both. They are neither far nor near. Whoever knows this and is free of conceit is liberated from the bonds of Māra. That view is not a view of any

phenomenon. What is not a view of any phenomenon at all is called right view, and in right view there is neither equal nor unequal. Because all phenomena are unmade, where nothing whatsoever is made equal or unequal, and nothing is left unmade either, that is liberation from the bonds of Māra."

When the seven hundred young goddesses had heard this explanation, they attained patience in conformity with the Dharma, and they said, "Son of noble family, we too have become untainted by the domain of Māra's bonds. We shall completely free all sentient beings bound by the bonds of Māra's domain from the bonds of Māra's domain."

Then the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta, whose name means "Untainted by the Domain of Māra's Activity," said to Māra the Evil One, "Evil One, these young goddesses, your attendants, have truly set out for awakening. What will you do now?"

Māra replied, "What can I do? I am bound by five bonds. I do not know what to do."

He said, "Evil One, generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and you will be completely freed from your bonds."

The young goddesses too felt compassion for the Evil One and said, "We beseech you, Evil One, generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Do not conceive of happiness as something to fear. Do not conceive of happiness as suffering. Do not conceive of liberation as bondage."

Then Māra the Evil One, deceitfully making as if to generate the mind set on awakening, said, "If you give back this generation of the awakening mind, I will generate the mind set on awakening."

The seven hundred young goddesses who had attained patience then, with skillful means, in order to free Māra the Evil One, reflected: "The generation of the mind set on omniscience by a single bodhisattva is the very same as the generation of mind of all bodhisattvas. There is nothing unequal in that mind; that mind is the mind of equality with all sentient beings. Therefore that mind is equality." Having thought this, they said, "We give up our generation of the mind set on awakening. Evil One, generate the mind set on awakening!"

Then Māra said to the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta, "Son of noble family, I generate the mind set on awakening. May I be freed from this bondage!" The very moment Māra the Evil One had spoken these words, he knew himself to

be free.

At that time the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta emitted from his body a light by which all the abodes of Māra became illuminated, and in which Māra the Evil One saw himself as dull and dark, like a heap of lampblack. He also displayed the perfection of his own body in this way.

Then, among the gods of Māra's realm, two hundred goddesses who indulged in desire and were given to attachment saw the perfect beauty of that bodhisattva's bodily form and became infatuated. Infatuated, they thought, "If this son of noble family would take delight with us, play with us and enjoy pleasures with us, we would come under the sway of his mind."

Then the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta, in order to tame the two hundred young goddesses, magically emanated two hundred young gods resembling the perfect beauty of his own bodily form, and he also emanated two hundred multistoried mansions surpassing the shape of Māra's celestial palace. The young goddesses perceived themselves as having entered them, and each one thought, "I am playing and delighting with him; I am enjoying pleasures with him." Then, when the stream of their craving for sensual pleasures had been cut off, all their wishes fulfilled, and their minds inclined to faith with superior intention, that holy being taught them the Dharma in just such a way that they would generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta said to Māra the Evil One, "Evil One, go before the Tathāgata."

Māra the Evil One thought, "I am freed from that bondage, so I will go and create obstacles."

Then Māra the Evil One, with his kin, his attendants and a great array, went to where the Blessed One, the Buddha, was, and said to him, "Blessed One, from now on do not teach this samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama). Why? Blessed One, whenever I hear the name of this samādhi of heroic progress, I find myself bound by five bonds of nooses. Therefore, Blessed One, it would be good if you spoke other discourses. From now on do not teach this samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to Māra the Evil One, "Evil One, who released you from that bondage?"

He replied, "The bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta released me from that bondage."

Dṛḍhamati asked, "Evil One, what kind of benefit did you render him in return?"

He replied, "I generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, Māra, the Evil One, generated the mind set on awakening in order to be freed from his bonds, and not with superior intention. In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, after I have passed into complete nirvāṇa, in a later age, at the end time, in the last five hundred years, many monks and nuns will generate the mind set on awakening out of desire for gain, honor, and renown, and not with superior intention.

"Dṛḍhamati, see how distinctive this samādhi of heroic progress is, and how great is the Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata! Dṛḍhamati, some monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen will hear this samādhi of heroic progress in order to mock it, or to disparage it, or to render service, or to follow others, or for gain, honor, and renown, and will generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. If even that becomes for them, Dṛḍhamati, a cause of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, what need is there to speak of those who hear this samādhi of heroic progress and generate the mind set on awakening with superior intention? They should be known as certain to attain the qualities of a buddha."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, Māra, the Evil One, heard this samādhi of heroic progress and generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening in order to be freed from his bonds. Will that become a cause for perfecting the qualities of a buddha?"

The Blessed One said: "It is so. Dṛḍhamati, through the root of virtue of having heard this samādhi of heroic progress, and through the root of virtue of this generation of the mind set on awakening, Māra, the Evil One, will purify all the deeds of Māra, all the conduct of Māra, all the deceit of Māra, all the trickery of Māra, and all crookedness. Having abandoned them, given them up completely, and cast them away, he will gradually attain this samādhi of heroic progress, and will fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. There will be a time and an occasion for that."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to Māra, the Evil One: "The Tathāgata has prophesied your unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Māra said: "Son of noble family, I did not generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening with superior intention, so how could the Tathāgata prophesy me? Son of noble family, the Tathāgata himself has declared, 'From mind comes karma, and from karma comes its ripening.' Son of noble family, since I have no such aspiration, how could the Tathāgata prophesy my unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?"

Then, to cut through the doubts of the whole assembly, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, there are these four kinds of prophecy given to bodhisattvas. What are the four? They are as follows. Dṛḍhamati, there is the prophecy given before the mind set on awakening has been generated. There is the prophecy given immediately upon generating that mind. There is the prophecy given in secret. And there is the prophecy given face to face, after patience has been attained. Dṛḍhamati, these are the four kinds of prophecy. They are fully known by the Tathāgata, but not by any śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas.

"Dṛḍhamati, what is the prophecy given before the mind set on awakening has been generated? Dṛḍhamati, here some person has been born in the saṃsāra of the five destinies, among the hell beings, or in the animal realm, or in the world of Yama, or among the gods, or among humans. If that person has sharp faculties and is inclined toward the vast, then the Tathāgata knows fully: 'After so many eons, so many hundreds of eons, so many thousands of eons, so many hundreds of thousands of eons, so many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons, this person will generate the mind set on awakening in the presence of such-and-such a tathāgata, and will generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening with superior intention. Practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva for so many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons, he will see so many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of buddhas. He will bring to maturity so many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of beings. After so many hundreds of thousands of incalculable eons, he will fully and perfectly awaken to awakening, and having attained awakening, he will be called by such a name. His buddha field will be like this. His saṅgha of śrāvakas will be this large. His saṅgha of bodhisattvas will be this large. His lifespan will be this long. After he has passed into complete nirvāṇa, his true Dharma will remain for this long.' Dṛḍhamati, the Tathāgata knows fully all this and even more. Dṛḍhamati, that is called the prophecy

given before the mind set on awakening has been generated."

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, from this day onward we shall regard all beings as the Teacher. Why is that? Because we do not have the wisdom that knows which beings have the faculties to mature toward awakening and which do not. Not knowing them, Blessed One, we form an inferior notion of such beings, and for that reason we come to ruin."

The Blessed One said: "Excellent, excellent! Kāśyapa, you have spoken those words well."

"Kāśyapa, it was because I too saw the force of this point that I taught you the Dharma in these words: 'Monks, do not judge persons. Monks, when one person judges another, he is ruined. Monks, only I, or others who are like me, may make such judgments.' Kāśyapa, according to this teaching, a bodhisattva or a śrāvaka should regard all sentient beings as the Teacher. Among them there may be some persons who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle, so in this one should guard oneself.

"Furthermore, Dṛḍhamati, there are some beings whose roots of virtue have fully ripened. They have planted the seeds and done the training. Their faculties are sharp, they are inclined toward the vast, and they are endowed with great compassion. They have set out in order to liberate all sentient beings completely. From the very moment they generate the mind, they are irreversible. They have entered the certainty of bodhisattvas, they are not liable to fall into wrong ways, and they have passed beyond the eight unfavorable conditions. As soon as they generate the mind, they are prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, with a declaration of their completely pure field, of their name, and of the end of their lifespan. Dṛḍhamati, when the Tathāgata, knowing the intention of such persons, prophesies them to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, that, Dṛḍhamati, is called the prophecy at the very moment of generating the mind.

"Dṛḍhamati, what then is the secret prophecy? Here, Dṛḍhamati, some bodhisattvas who have been slack strive with diligence for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening all the more, the longer they remain unprophesied. Such a bodhisattva is inclined toward every kind of giving, because he gives away all that he owns. He remains firm in his vows, because he never gives up the whole of moral discipline. Being even-minded toward all

sentient beings, he has donned the armor of the power of patience. Seeking every virtuous quality as though his head and his clothes were on fire, he has taken up diligence. Being a meditator in the meditative concentrations, he is skilled in mindfulness and vigilance. Having entered the conduct of a bodhisattva, he has an intelligence that investigates with wisdom. He practices these six perfections, but he still does so with signs and with deliberate effort.

"Then other bodhisattvas, together with gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras and garuḍas, think: 'This bodhisattva's diligence is wonderful! How long will it be before he fully awakens to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? When he attains awakening, what will his name be? What will his buddha field be like? What will his Saṅgha of śrāvakas be like? What will his Saṅgha of bodhisattvas be like?' To cut through the doubts of those beings, the Tathāgata prophesies that bodhisattva to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, in such a way that the entire assembly hears, knows and understands it. That is, through the blessing of the Tathāgata, that bodhisattva neither knows nor sees nor hears it, while the whole assembly hears, sees and knows: 'When this bodhisattva attains awakening, he will be called by this name. His buddha field will be like this. His Saṅgha of śrāvakas will be like this. His Saṅgha of bodhisattvas will be like this. His lifespan will be this long.' When they have heard it, they are free of hesitation, free of uncertainty and free of doubt, and they come to regard that bodhisattva as a teacher, as a tathāgata, and as a guide. Yet that bodhisattva does not know, see or understand that he has been prophesied by the Tathāgata. This is the secret prophecy of a bodhisattva: through the blessing of the Tathāgata, the foremost of the herd, the prophecy given to the bodhisattva is heard by the entire assembly, but that bodhisattva himself does not hear it.

"What then is the prophecy given face to face once patience has been attained? Here, Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva has gathered roots of virtue. For a long time he has practiced pure conduct without any objectification, and he has attained patience with the selflessness of phenomena and patience with the nonarising of phenomena. Knowing that he has attained patience with the nonarising of phenomena, the tathāgatas address him before the world with its gods, and before the assembly with its māras and Brahmās, its śramaṇas and brahmins: 'Son of noble family, come here! After so many hundreds of thousands of eons you will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. When you have attained awakening, you will be called by this name. Your buddha field will be like this. Your Saṅgha of śrāvakas will be like

this. Your Saṅgha of bodhisattvas will be like this. Your lifespan will be this long.' In this way they prophesy the one who has attained patience to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening with a face-to-face prophecy, and by following his example countless sentient beings will also generate the mind set on awakening. When that bodhisattva hears the prophecy face to face, he rises into the sky to the height of seven palm trees. Dṛḍhamati, that is called the fourth prophecy of a bodhisattva."

Fourth fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, among the bodhisattvas gathered here in this assembly, are there any who have been prophesied with these four prophecies?"

The Blessed One said, "There are, Dṛḍhamati."

He asked, "Who are they?"

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, this bodhisattva Siṃhanādanādin and this son of the householder Lover of Delight were prophesied without having generated the awakening mind. In other world systems besides this one, too, there are countless bodhisattvas who have been prophesied with the prophecy given before generating the mind set on awakening.

"Dṛḍhamati, there are this bodhisattva Endowed with Peace, this Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, and, in other world systems besides this one, those bodhisattvas who were prophesied to be irreversible the very moment they first set their minds on awakening. These are the countless ones who have received a prophecy of that kind.

"Dṛḍhamati, there are this bodhisattva Hero of Wisdom, this bodhisattva Viśeṣamati, and, in other world systems besides this one, those bodhisattvas who were prophesied in secret. These are the countless ones who have received a secret prophecy.

"Dṛḍhamati, I myself, this bodhisattva Maitreya, and all the bodhisattvas who will appear in this Fortunate Eon attained forbearance and were then prophesied in person. We are the ones who have received a prophecy in person."

The bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said, "Blessed One, the conduct of bodhisattvas is inconceivable in this way. From their inconceivable conduct all the way to their prophecy, it is inconceivable and wondrous. It is beyond the reach even of all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, let alone of any other beings."

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, so it is. It is just as you have said. Dṛḍhamati, all the disciplined conduct of bodhisattvas is inconceivable."

Then the daughters of the gods of Māra's realm, whom the bodhisattva Untainted by the Sphere of Māra's Activity had ripened toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, scattered flowers, garlands, incense, powders and unguents over the Blessed One and said:

"Blessed One, may we not be among those who receive a secret prophecy. Blessed One, may we attain forbearance and then be among those who receive a prophecy in person. Blessed One, it would be excellent if the Tathāgata would prophesy us in person to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening once we have attained forbearance."

At that moment the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, this is what happens: many colors, various colors, many hundreds of thousands of colors, namely blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, the color of crystal and the color of silver, came forth from his mouth. They filled endless, boundless world systems with light, rose up as high as the world of Brahmā, and with their splendor outshone the splendor of the sun and moon. Then they returned, circled the Blessed One many hundreds of thousands of times, and vanished into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. He bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One and said to him, "Blessed One, what is the cause of your smile? What is the condition?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, do you see these nine hundred daughters of the gods, who are paying homage to the Tathāgata with palms joined?"

He replied, "I see them, Blessed One. I see them, Sugata."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, these nine hundred daughters of the gods have generated roots of virtue in the presence of five hundred buddhas. Hereafter they will show respect, render service, honor and make offerings to countless tathāgatas, and after seven hundred incalculable eons they will become tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, each called Dharmavyūharāja. Ānanda, when these daughters of the gods die and pass from here, the moment they have died they will be transformed out of a woman's body. In the abode of Tuṣita they will keep company with the

bodhisattva Maitreya and please him, and in due course they will please all the tathāgatas of the Fortunate Eon. Having pleased them, they will never displease them; they will render service, show respect, honor them and make offerings to them."

Then Māra, the Wicked One, realizing that those daughters of the gods had been prophesied, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, if those of my servants and retinue who have heard this samādhi of heroic progress no longer come under my power, how much less will they follow my wishes! Blessed One, I know for certain that to hear this samādhi of heroic progress is to belong to the Dharma of the Buddha."

Then those daughters of the gods, without losing heart, said to Māra, the Wicked One:

"Wicked One, do not say that, and do not despair! We neither pass beyond your domain nor turn away from it. Why is that? The suchness that enters Māra's domain is the very suchness that enters the Buddha's domain. So the suchness that enters Māra's domain and the suchness that enters the Buddha's domain are not two, and cannot be divided into two. Therefore, Wicked One, we do not pass beyond suchness.

"The nature of reality of Māra's domain is also the nature of reality of the Buddha's domain. So the nature of reality of Māra's domain and the nature of reality of the Buddha's domain are not two, and cannot be divided into two. Therefore, Wicked One, we do not pass beyond the nature of reality.

"Māra's domain does not cognize any phenomenon whatsoever, and the Buddha's domain does not cognize any phenomenon whatsoever. So Māra's domain and the Buddha's domain do not cognize. Therefore, Wicked One, no phenomenon is a domain that cognizes. Therefore, Wicked One, we are no one's servants, nor are we not servants."

Then Māra, the Wicked One, suffering, unhappy and displeased, wished to leave, and the bodhisattva Untainted by the Sphere of Māra's Activity said to him, "Wicked One, where are you going?"

He replied, "Son of noble family, I am going to my abode."

The bodhisattva said, "Then, Wicked One, without stirring from this assembly, stay in your own abode as well!"

Then Māra, the Wicked One, perceived that he had gone to his own abode.

Then the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta said this: "Wicked One, what do you see?"

Māra said, "I see that I have gone to my own abode. Son of good family, these delightful parks, these delightful groves, these delightful ponds, and these delightful rivers are the abode of Māra."

Then the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta said this to Māra the Wicked One: "Wicked One, offer this abode to the Tathāgata for his use."

He said, "I offer it."

And by that he saw the Tathāgata, together with his assembly, dwelling in his own abode, explaining and teaching this samādhi of heroic progress.

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One (the Buddha): "Blessed One, how great will be the merit of the donor, the patron, the owner of the monastery in whose monastery the Tathāgata dwells, explaining and teaching this samādhi of heroic progress, and whose food he eats while explaining this samādhi of heroic progress?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, the food the Tathāgata ate when he attained awakening, the food he ate when he turned the wheel of Dharma, and the food he ate when he taught this samādhi of heroic progress: among those foods there is no difference whatsoever.

"Ānanda, the spot of ground where awakening is attained, that vajra-like spot, is used by the blessed ones of the past, the future, and the present. Ānanda, just as with that seat of awakening, so too should one regard any spot of ground where this samādhi of heroic progress is taught, explained, written down, or transmitted.

"Ānanda, the food the Tathāgata ate when he turned the wheel of Dharma, and the food of whatever donor or patron a preacher of the Dharma eats while explaining, teaching, transmitting, or reciting this samādhi of heroic progress: among those foods there is no difference whatsoever.

"Ānanda, the monastery in which the Tathāgata dwells and tames beings through the eighteen great miracles, and any monastery, dwelling, or walking place where this samādhi of heroic progress is explained, taught, read, written down, or recited: Ānanda, among those monasteries there is no difference whatsoever."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to Māra the Wicked One: "Wicked One, in offering your dwelling to the Tathāgata for his use, you have gained a fine gain indeed."

Māra said, "Ānanda, this is the blessing of the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta. It is the bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta who performs these magical displays."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One: "The bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta abides in this samādhi of heroic progress and performs these magical displays."

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, it is so. The bodhisattva Māragocarānupalipta, abiding in this samādhi of heroic progress, performs these magical displays. Though he is not tainted by the domain of Māra's activity, he displays all the conduct of the domain of Māra's activity. Though he does not indulge in the pleasure of sexual union, he also appears coupling, two with two. Abiding in this samādhi, that son of good family shows himself dwelling in Māra's own abode, yet he does not stir from the assembly of the Tathāgata. Dṛḍhamati, a bodhisattva abiding in this samādhi shows the māras the domain of Māra, and also brings them to maturity in the Dharma of the Buddha."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, it would be excellent if the Blessed One would tell even a portion of what he practiced: what arrays of magical displays the Tathāgata showed when he was formerly a bodhisattva, abiding in this samādhi of heroic progress."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati: "Dṛḍhamati, I abided in this samādhi of heroic progress. In this great trichiliocosm there are a billion four-continent world systems, a billion suns and moons, a billion realms of the gods of the Four Great Kings, a billion gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, a billion Yāma gods, a billion Tuṣita gods, a billion Nirmāṇarati heavens, a billion Paranirmitavaśavartin heavens, a billion abodes of Māra, a billion abodes of Brahmā, and likewise a billion of each up to Akaniṣṭha, a billion Mount Merus, kings of mountains, and a billion great oceans. All these together are called a great trichiliocosm. Dṛḍhamati, in this way a bodhisattva, a great being, abiding in the samādhi of heroic progress, in this great trichiliocosm, practices the perfection of generosity in some Jambudvīpas, practices the perfection of moral discipline in some Jambudvīpas, practices the perfection of patience in some Jambudvīpas,

practices the perfection of diligence in some Jambudvīpas, practices the perfection of meditative concentration in some Jambudvīpas, and practices the Perfection of Wisdom in some Jambudvīpas.

In some Jambudvīpas he appears endowed with the five superknowledges. In some Jambudvīpas he appears as one who lives in a household. In some Jambudvīpas he appears as one who has gone forth. In some Jambudvīpas he appears dwelling in the abode of Tuṣita. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a householder and merchant. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a caravan leader. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as the king of a region. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a minister. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a universal monarch (cakravartin). In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a universal monarch who rules by force. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a king of the land. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as Brahmā. In some he is known as the lord of the gods of the Four Great Kings. In some he is known as the lord of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. In some he is known as the lord of the Yāma gods. In some he is known as the lord of the Tuṣita gods. In some he is known as the lord of the Nirmāṇarati gods. In some he is known as the lord of the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods. In some he is known as Māra.

In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a merchant. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a householder. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as the king of a region. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a prince. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a minister. In some Jambudvīpas he is known as a caravan leader. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be passing away from Tuṣita. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be entering his mother's womb. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be dwelling in his mother's womb. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be taking birth. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be taking seven steps. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be looking in the four directions and roaring the lion's roar, "In the world I am the chief; in the world I am supreme." In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be dwelling amid his retinue of consorts. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be renouncing the world. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be practicing austerities. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be partaking of food. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be accepting grass. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be going to the seat of awakening. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be seated at the seat of awakening. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be subduing Māra. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be attaining awakening.

In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be sitting, having attained awakening. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be practicing meditative concentration after attaining awakening. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be entreated by Śakra and Brahmā. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be turning the wheel of Dharma. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be performing the various deeds of a buddha. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be relinquishing the formations of life. In some he is known to be passing into final nirvāṇa. In some he is known to have passed into final nirvāṇa. In some he is known to be undergoing cremation. In some he is known to have been cremated. In some Jambudvīpas his body is known to have remained solid in a single piece. In some his relics are known to be being distributed. In some the Dharma is known to be on the point of disappearing. In some the Dharma is known to have disappeared. In some his life is known to be immeasurable. In some his life is known to be short. In some it is known that there is talk of rebirth in the lower realms. In some it is known that there is not even talk of rebirth in the lower realms. In some Jambudvīpa is known to resemble the riches of the gods. In some, because beings do not grasp at "I" and "mine," Jambudvīpa is known to resemble the northern continent of Uttarakuru. In some it is known as a continent of jewels. In some it is known as a continent of earth. In some it is known as superior, in some as middling, and in some as inferior.

This, Dṛḍhamati, is the bull-like preeminence of the samādhi of heroic progress. Therefore, look how bodhisattvas, by passing utterly into final nirvāṇa, do not pass into final nirvāṇa, and how here in this great trichiliocosm too they display their play through arrays such as these. Dṛḍhamati, here in this Jambudvīpa he is even now turning the wheel of Dharma, while in other Jambudvīpas he is known not yet to have attained perfect, complete awakening. In some he is known to have passed into final nirvāṇa. In some Jambudvīpas he is known to be first generating the mind of awakening. This, Dṛḍhamati, is the bull-like preeminence of the samādhi of heroic progress.

Then some of the bodhisattvas in that assembly, and the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great mahoragas, humans and nonhumans, and the great śrāvakas thought, "Is such an array of play displayed only in this very great trichiliocosm, or does the Blessed One Śākyamuni also engage in the domain of a buddha in other great trichiliocosms?"

Then Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, in order to cut through the doubts of that assembly, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, regarding this: while I

was practicing conduct within the domain of the buddhas, I went upward from this buddhafield, passing beyond as many buddhafields as the sands of sixty Ganges rivers, and in a world system called Single Lamp a tathāgata was teaching the Dharma. Blessed One, I went into the presence of that tathāgata, bowed my head at the tathāgata's feet, and said this: 'Blessed One, what is your name? How should I keep it in mind?' That tathāgata said to me, 'Mañjuśrī, go and ask that very Tathāgata Śākyamuni, and he himself will answer you.' The array of qualities of that Blessed One's buddhafield could not be praised to the end even in an eon, nor could its causes of happiness be described; such is the array of qualities of that buddhafield. Even the names of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are not heard there. Its Saṅgha is utterly pure, made up of bodhisattvas who teach the wheel of the irreversible Dharma. Blessed One, I beg the Tathāgata kindly to declare the name of the tathāgata who is now teaching the Dharma in the world system Single Lamp."

When he had requested this, the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful:

"Therefore, Mañjuśrī, listen well and thoroughly, and keep it in mind, and I will explain it to you. Having heard it, you should not be frightened, you should not be alarmed, you should not become terrified, you should not doubt, and you should not waver. Why is that? The buddha-abiding of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is inconceivable, and entry into the field of activity of the samādhi of heroic progress is likewise inconceivable.

"Mañjuśrī, in the world system called Single Lamp there is the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, King of Magical Display Who Appears to Teach All Qualities. That Tathāgata who teaches the Dharma, Mañjuśrī, is I myself. In that world system called Single Lamp I am known as King of Magical Display Who Appears to Teach All Qualities, and it lies within my own domain as a buddha. Mañjuśrī, it is I myself who turn the irreversible wheel of Dharma there. That buddha field is one that I myself purified in the past. Mañjuśrī, in this way my domain extends into hundreds of thousands of koṭis of trillions of buddha fields. All the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas cannot fathom it. That is because a bodhisattva teaches the Dharma to beings in immeasurable buddha fields, yet does not move from this samādhi or from the realm of phenomena. This, Mañjuśrī, is the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this. The orb of the sun or the orb of the moon does not move from its celestial palace, yet it shows itself in villages, towns, market

towns, districts, provinces and royal palaces. Blind beings, however, neither know it nor see it. Because it appears and is known according to the capacity of the vessel, that celestial palace appears to beings in the measure that the karma of their eyes is purified. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, the buddhas, the blessed ones, and the bodhisattvas abide in this samādhi of heroic progress, and without moving from this maṇḍala of samādhi, and without moving from the maṇḍala of the realm of phenomena, they show themselves to beings in immeasurable buddha fields, and they teach the Dharma to beings in accordance with their inclinations. Beings who have not become vessels, however, neither know nor see, just as the mind of the blind does not."

Then that entire assembly was filled with wonder and remained in joy, faith and supreme delight. The gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans scattered flower petals over the Tathāgata. They also played cymbals, and they scattered flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands and ointments as well. The great śrāvakas, too, each placed their own upper robes upon the body of the Tathāgata. And the bodhisattvas scattered over the Tathāgata canopies of flowers as vast as Mount Meru, together with sandalwood, perfumes, garlands, powders and ointments, and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, the place on earth where this samādhi of heroic progress is practiced is like a vajra. Blessed One, those beings who, having heard this samādhi of heroic progress explained, are drawn to it and have faith in it, who are not frightened, not alarmed and do not become terrified, but who take it up, retain it, read it, master it and explain it, they too will become like a vajra. They will be of unbreakable patience, established in faith, embraced by the Tathāgata, having thoroughly cultivated roots of virtue, having gained what is well worth gaining, having vanquished Māra and their adversaries, having cut off transgressions, and being well embraced by spiritual friends. As I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has said, those beings who are drawn to this samādhi of heroic progress as soon as they hear it will become certain in the Dharma of the Buddha."

The Blessed One said, "Noble son, so it is. It is just as you have said. Beings who have not generated roots of virtue cannot have faith in this teaching when they hear it. Noble son, the beings who become drawn to this samādhi of heroic progress are few. Those who reject it and are not drawn to it are many.

"Noble son, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities is able to be drawn to this samādhi. What are the four? He has previously heard this samādhi from the perfectly complete buddhas of the past; he is embraced by spiritual friends and abides in superior intention; he has accumulated roots of virtue and is drawn to the vast; and he has bodily witnessed this Great Vehicle. Noble sons, for those who possess these four qualities it is easy to be drawn to this samādhi or to have faith in it.

"Even arhats who have completed their investigation, those perfect in view, stream-enterers and faith-followers are drawn to it through faith in the Tathāgata, but it is not directly evident to them. Noble sons, if even all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas cannot realize and comprehend it, what need is there to speak of other beings?"

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, it is like this. Suppose some blind man falls asleep and in a dream gains sight and sees all kinds of forms. In his dream he is satisfied, pleased and delighted; overjoyed, with joy and happiness arising, he stands, goes about, walks and talks with other beings who have eyes. But, Blessed One, when that blind man wakes up, he is simply blind, and he does not see forms. In the same way, Blessed One, before we had heard this samädhi of heroic progress, we were delighted, joy and happiness had arisen in us, and 'We possess the divine eye,'

we thought, and we would speak with bodhisattvas. But now that we have heard this samādhi of heroic progress from the Blessed One, we have become blind. We do not know and do not see how the Tathāgata abides in this samādhi of heroic progress, or how bodhisattvas practice. Blessed One, because I do not know the activity within the domain of the buddhas, from this day on I regard myself as one who is blind. Those bodhisattvas who have attained this patience regarding knowledge I hold to possess the divine eye, and to them I shall pay homage. Blessed One, without the mind of omniscience, who would claim of himself, 'I possess wisdom,' or 'I am worthy of offerings'? It is bodhisattvas who will realize that wisdom."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, Kāśyapa, excellent! It is so; it is just as you have said. The realization that comes through the wisdom of the śrāvakas does not enter into this. That realization through wisdom is fathomed by bodhisattvas."

When the elder Mahākāśyapa had explained this teaching, a hundred thousand living beings, gods and humans, gave rise to the mind set on

unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, "Mañjuśrī, people speak of 'one worthy of offerings, one worthy of offerings.' Mañjuśrī, to what extent is one called worthy of offerings?"

Mañjuśrī said, "Son of good family, one worthy of offerings is one who possesses ten qualities. What are the ten? They are these: one abides in the three doors of liberation, emptiness, signlessness and wishlessness, yet does not enter into the certainty of the śrāvakas; one fully understands the Four Truths, yet does not attain the fruit; one is a meditator in the meditative concentrations of the eight liberations, yet does not abandon the conduct of a bodhisattva; one possesses the three knowledges, yet acts within the three realms; one abides in the color, emblem and form of a śrāvaka, yet does not follow after sounds or seek learning from others; one abides in the color, emblem and form of a pratyekabuddha, yet teaches the Dharma with unobstructed eloquence; one rests alone in meditative equipoise, yet appears in the activities for ripening all sentient beings; one does not stray from the path, yet appears on bad paths; one appears to be utterly attached, yet, being free from all afflictions, is free from desire; one has passed completely into nirvāṇa, yet neither disrupts nor abandons the conduct of saṃsāra. Son of good family, one who possesses these ten qualities is called worthy of offerings."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to the elder Subhūti, "The Blessed One has declared the elder Subhūti supreme among those worthy of offerings. Is the elder Subhūti to be found among those ten qualities that Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, has explained?"

When he had said this, the elder Subhūti said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Son of good family, I do not have even one of those qualities, so what need is there to speak of ten?"

He said, "Then how is the elder Subhūti called supreme among those worthy of offerings?"

Subhūti said, "Son of good family, the Blessed One did not declare that I am supreme among those worthy of offerings in comparison with bodhisattvas, or with tathāgatas and pratyekabuddhas. Son of good family, the Blessed One declared that I am supreme among those worthy of offerings in comparison with the śrāvakas. Dṛḍhamati, it is like this. Suppose someone dwells on a borderland island and is spoken of as 'the regional king, the regional king.' But

when a wheel-turning king goes to that borderland island, the other is no longer called a regional king; because this one is a wheel-turning king, the wheel-turning king outshines that regional king. In the same way, Dṛḍhamati, in villages, cities and market towns where no bodhisattva dwells, I am counted as 'worthy of offerings.' But when a tathāgata is present there, or someone who has truly entered the Great Vehicle dwells there, then I am not counted as 'worthy of offerings,' for I am outshone by the bodhisattva's mind of omniscience."

Then the Blessed One gave the elder Subhūti his approval, saying, "Excellent!" and said, "Subhūti, excellent, excellent, that you, a great śrāvaka free from conceit, have shown this in this way."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, "Mañjuśrī, people speak of 'one who is learned, one who is learned.' Mañjuśrī, to what extent is one learned?"

Mañjuśrī said, "Son of good family, 'one who is learned, one who is learned' means this. Son of good family, when, the moment one has heard it, one analyzes the answer to a question on a single word of a door of the Dharma in hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of ways, and even if one were to teach it for an eon or for a hundred eons, one's words and eloquence on that door of the Dharma would not run short, then one is called learned. Dṛḍhamati, to that extent one is called learned.

"Furthermore, Dṛḍhamati, one retains everything taught by the immeasurable, countless buddhas, the blessed ones, of the ten directions, yet not a single word of it strikes one's ear as something not heard before. Whatever one hears, all of it is a hearing of what has already been heard, not a hearing that comes out of not having heard. Because one has become someone of unforgetting nature, one retains everything just as one heard it. And because there are no sentient beings, one teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in this way, yet forms no perception of the many kinds of conceptualizing about a self, about sentient beings, or about phenomena. Dṛḍhamati, to that extent one is called learned."

Then a young god called Essence of the Stainless Moon joined that same assembly. Seated there, he said to the venerable Ānanda, "The Blessed One has declared, 'The elder Ānanda is foremost among the learned.' So, elder Ānanda, do you possess learning of the kind that Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, has explained?"

Ānanda said, "Young god, I do not. I do not possess learning of the kind that Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, has explained."

He said, "Then in what sense has the Blessed One declared, 'The elder Ānanda is foremost among the learned'?"

Ānanda said, "Young god, the Blessed One declared, 'I am foremost among the learned,' taking as his measure those śrāvakas of the Blessed One who follow the words of others, who aspire to the words of others, and who are intent upon liberation. Young god, he did not declare that I am foremost in learning among the bodhisattvas, whose ocean of wisdom is unobstructed and immeasurable, and whose wisdom and eloquence are inexhaustible.

"Young god, it is just as the people of Jambudvīpa carry out their work and see forms by the light of the sun and the moon. In the same way, young god, this light of wisdom belongs to the Tathāgata. Therefore I retain the Dharma just as the Blessed One has taught it. Young god, in this I do not regard it as the power of a person; I regard it as the power of the Buddha's person."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the elder Ānanda: "Excellent, excellent, Ānanda! It is just so. It is as you have said. You master things through the power of the Buddha."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the young god Essence of the Stainless Moon: "Young god, the teachings the monk Ānanda has mastered are few; those he has not mastered are immeasurable. Young god, of all the Dharma and Vinaya to which the Tathāgata has fully awakened, I have not taught even a ten-millionth part, a ten-thousand-millionth part, or a fraction of a hundred-thousand-ten-millionth part. And of what I have taught, the monk Ānanda has not retained even a hundred-thousand-ten-millionth part.

"Young god, suppose that for a single day and night I were to teach the Śakras, the Brahmās, the world guardians, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas and gandharvas, and the bodhisattvas who have come from the world systems of the ten directions: giving discourses connected with the Dharma, explaining the analysis of questions, and expounding the discourses, the sung verses, the expositions, the verses, the inspired utterances, the narratives, the introductory accounts, the 'thus it happened' accounts, the birth stories, the extensive teachings, the marvelous teachings, and the definitive instructions; explaining how beings' conduct unfolds, explaining the complete fulfillment of the perfections, explaining the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, explaining the faults of saṃsāra, and explaining the benefits of the qualities of

nirvāṇa. Young god, the full and detailed analysis of that teaching of the Dharma would not easily be mastered in its entirety, even in a hundred thousand eons, by learned beings like the monk Ānanda, as numerous as the particles of dust in Jambudvīpa.

"Young god, by this line of reasoning as well, you should understand it like this: the Tathāgata's teaching of the Dharma is thus immeasurable. Of it, the monk Ānanda has mastered only a little; what he has not mastered is immeasurable."

Then the young god Essence of the Stainless Moon offered the Blessed One a hundred thousand parasols made of the seven precious substances. Those parasols could be seen covering the sky, and the bodies of all the beings whom the parasols covered appeared golden in color. Having offered those parasols to the Blessed One, the young god spoke these words: "Blessed One, through this root of virtue of mine, may all beings come to possess eloquence and the power to teach the Dharma, just as the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma and just as Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, retains the Dharma through his mindfulness."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the superior intention of that young god, said, "Dṛḍhamati, after forty-four thousand eons this young god will become the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Single Jewel Parasol, in the buddha field called Adorned with All Jewels." Thus he prophesied that young god's unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

When this was said, two hundred beings in that assembly who belonged to the bodhisattva vehicle became discouraged. They thought, "The qualities of a buddha are like that! It is so difficult to attain omniscience. We cannot complete that state, so we had better pass into final nirvāṇa through the pratyekabuddha vehicle. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has said that a bodhisattva who turns back attains individual awakening."

Then Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, in order to uplift the minds of those two hundred discouraged bodhisattvas, thinking, "Ah, these beings have the fortune to fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening," and for the sake of training them, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I recall that in the past there was an eon called Illumination. Blessed One, in that eon called Illumination, I passed into final nirvāṇa through the pratyekabuddha vehicle three million six hundred thousand koṭi-niyutas of times."

Then that whole assembly fell into doubt: "What is this? Since in parinirvāṇa there is no linking to a new birth, how can Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, say, 'Blessed One, I recall that in the Illumination eon I passed into parinirvāṇa through the pratyekabuddha vehicle three million six hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of times'?"

Then, through the power of the Buddha, the venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, since in parinirvāṇa there is no linking to a new birth, how is it that Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, after passing into nirvāṇa, links to a new birth?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, ask Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, himself, and he will answer you."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful: "Mañjuśrī, since in parinirvāṇa there is no going and no linking to a new birth, how is it, Mañjuśrī, that you say, 'Blessed One, I recall that in the Illumination eon I passed into parinirvāṇa through the pratyekabuddha vehicle three million six hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of times'? How should the meaning of what you have said be understood?"

When he had said this, Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, said this to the venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, the Tathāgata is all-knowing, all-seeing; he speaks the truth, he speaks correctly, and he does not deceive. He cannot be deceived by the world with its gods. Here the matter rests with me: if I were to say anything otherwise, I would be deceiving the Tathāgata.

"So it was, Venerable Śāriputra: at that time, on that occasion, in the Illumination eon, there appeared a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha called Jina. Having worked for the benefit of the world with its gods, he passed into parinirvāṇa. After he had passed into parinirvāṇa, the true Dharma remained for a hundred thousand years. Then, Venerable Śāriputra, when that true Dharma had disappeared, those beings came to depend on the power of conditions. Except that they could be tamed by the conduct of a pratyekabuddha, even if a hundred thousand buddhas had taught them the Dharma, they would not have been inclined toward the Dharma being taught; those beings were inclined solely toward the pratyekabuddha vehicle.

"Venerable Śāriputra, at that time, on that occasion, there was not a single pratyekabuddha to whom those beings could make offerings. So, Śāriputra, in order to bring those beings to maturity, I declared myself a pratyekabuddha, and in whatever village, city, market town, district, or royal palace I stayed,

there I was taken to be a pratyekabuddha. Because I displayed both the conduct of a pratyekabuddha and the appearance of a pratyekabuddha, those beings, with reverence, served me and gave me alms. Having accepted those alms, I taught the Dharma to as many of those beings as were fit vessels. And having taught, I rose into the sky like a king of geese. Then those beings, having gained faith in me, bowed down and spoke these words: 'May we too attain those qualities!'

"Venerable Śāriputra, in this way I brought many beings to maturity in the roots of virtue. When I knew, 'Ah, these beings have grown through the alms,' I then announced, 'Friends, the time has come for me to pass into parinirvāṇa; I am passing into parinirvāṇa.' Then many hundreds of thousands of beings came carrying flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, and ointments. I entered the meditative attainment of the cessation of perception and feeling, and through the power of my aspiration I passed into parinirvāṇa. Those beings, knowing that I had passed into parinirvāṇa, cremated the body. Having cremated it, they built a stupa, and they performed acts of worship at that stupa. Thus, Venerable Śāriputra, there I was taken to have passed into parinirvāṇa.

"Then, a second time, I went to another royal palace and declared myself a pratyekabuddha. Those beings too took me to be a pratyekabuddha and gave me alms, and among them too I displayed passing into parinirvāṇa, and they too made offerings to me as one who had passed into parinirvāṇa.

"Venerable Śāriputra, in this way, during that intermediate eon of Illumination, I passed into parinirvāṇa in the pratyekabuddha vehicle three million six hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of times, and in all the royal palaces I tamed three hundred sixty million living beings in the pratyekabuddha vehicle. Venerable Śāriputra, that is passing into parinirvāṇa through the pratyekabuddha vehicle, yet one does not utterly pass into parinirvāṇa."

As soon as Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, had given this answer, this great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, quaked in six ways, and it was filled with a great light. Hundreds of thousands of gods rained down flowers in order to worship Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, and they gave voice to the sound of a wondrous and marvelous Dharma. They uttered this exclamation: "Blessed One, we have seen the Tathāgata and Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, and we have heard this samādhi of heroic progress. We have truly gained what is well worth gaining!"

"Blessed One, it is wondrous that Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, possesses such inconceivable qualities! Blessed One, in what samādhi does Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, abide, that he displays this inconceivable nature of reality?"

The Blessed One said, "Young gods, Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, abides here in the samādhi of heroic progress and so displays this inconceivable nature of reality. When a bodhisattva abides in that samādhi, he is a follower by faith, and yet he does not go by the faith of others. He is a follower of the Dharma, and yet he does not fall away from the nature of reality or from turning the wheel of Dharma. He is one of the eighth rank, and yet for the sake of beings who have fallen into the eight wrong ways he practices for incalculable eons. He is a stream-enterer, and yet, for the sake of beings swept along by the stream, he does not fall into the faultless state of the śrāvakas. He is a once-returner, and yet he appears in all world systems. He is a non-returner, and yet he comes back in order to bring beings to maturity. He is an arhat, and yet he has undertaken diligence in order to seek out the qualities of a buddha. He is a hearer, and yet, because his eloquence never ceases, he teaches the Dharma to all beings. He is a pratyekabuddha, and yet for the sake of beings who rely on the strength of conditions he practices for incalculable eons. For the sake of beings for whom conditions have great power he displays final nirvāṇa, and yet by the power of samādhi he is born again. Young gods, in this way a bodhisattva who abides in this samādhi of heroic progress is designated by every designation of the noble ones. He teaches the Dharma to beings according to whatever stage they abide in, and yet he does not himself abide in that stage."

The fifth and final fascicle.

Then those young gods, having heard that explanation, rejoiced greatly and said, "Blessed One, those beings who have entered the faultless state of the śrāvakas and those who have entered the faultless state of the pratyekabuddhas are tied up in a knot. Blessed One, those beings have fallen away from this samādhi of heroic progress.

"Blessed One, it is good for one who has committed the five deeds of immediate retribution to hear this samādhi of heroic progress, but it is not so for an arhat whose defilements are exhausted. Why is that? Blessed One, when one who has committed the five deeds of immediate retribution hears this samādhi of heroic progress, he also generates the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Although, because of the evil

karma he committed before, he will go to hell, he will nevertheless also enter into the samādhi of heroic progress. But an arhat whose defilements are exhausted, thoroughly trained, has not become a vessel; what could he do with the samādhi of heroic progress?

"Blessed One, it is like this. Suppose, for example, that a great distribution of honey, ghee, or sesame oil is being held, and many people come carrying vessels. If one man there, through a lapse of mindfulness, lets his vessel break, then even though he has come to the place where the honey, ghee, and sesame oil are being given away, because his vessel is broken he can do nothing. He may take his own fill and leave, but he cannot carry any away in order to bring it to other beings and share it with them. Blessed One, those people who have vessels both take their own fill and fill their vessels completely and carry them away, and so they sustain other beings as well.

"Furthermore, Blessed One, what is called the great offering-distribution of honey, ghee, and sesame oil is a figure for the Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata. What is said, that the man with the broken vessel may take his fill and go but cannot carry anything away, is a figure for the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Blessed One, what is called the man who has a vessel is a figure for the bodhisattvas, who have set out for the benefit of themselves and the benefit of others."

Then those two hundred bodhisattvas whose minds had grown discouraged and who had come to wish to return to their own former disposition heard this explanation of the young gods and the inconceivable merit of Mañjuśrī, the Youthful. With superior intention they generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and that generation of the mind became linked with awakening. They also spoke these words: "Blessed One, we would gladly give up our lives, but we will not give up sentient beings. Blessed One, by the root of virtue of having generated the strength to hear this samādhi of heroic progress, may we obtain the ten powers of a bodhisattva! What are the ten? They are: the power of superior intention in the awakening mind; the power of faith in the qualities of a buddha; the power of not forgetting what has been widely heard; the power of never wearying of saṃsāra; the power of steadfast great compassion for sentient beings; the power of a mind that increases giving; the power of unimpaired, correct training in moral discipline; the power of patience and acceptance; the power of the wisdom that subdues Māra; and the power of devotion to the profound Dharma. Blessed One, may we obtain these ten powers of a bodhisattva!"

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Dṛḍhamati, whether now or after I have passed away, whoever listens to and hears this samādhi of heroic progress and has devotion to it, all of them will come to possess these ten powers of a bodhisattva."

At that time a bodhisattva, a great being called Jinamati, had joined that assembly and was seated there. Then the bodhisattva, the great being Jinamati, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, a son or daughter of good family who seeks merit should make offerings to the Tathāgata. One who seeks wisdom should exert himself in learning. One who seeks the higher realms should guard moral discipline. One who seeks wealth should increase generosity.

One who seeks beauty of form should cultivate patience. One who seeks eloquence should show respect to the teacher. One who seeks dhāraṇī should be without pride. One who seeks wisdom should be endowed with proper attention. One who seeks happiness should commit no wrongdoing whatsoever. One who seeks to work for the benefit of sentient beings should give rise to the mind set on awakening. One who seeks a pleasing renown should speak the truth. One who seeks good qualities should delight in deep solitude. One who seeks the Dharma should rely on a spiritual friend. One who seeks calm abiding should not have much busyness. One who seeks insight should often examine phenomena as empty. One who seeks the world of Brahmā should cultivate the four immeasurables. One who seeks the excellence of gods and humans should take up and abide by the path of the ten virtuous actions. One who seeks to pass into nirvāṇa should have faith that phenomena are empty.

"Blessed One, in this way the sons and daughters of good family who seek merit, who seek wisdom, who seek the higher realms, who seek wealth, who seek beauty of form, who seek eloquence, who seek dhāraṇī, who seek primordial wisdom, who seek happiness, who seek the benefit of sentient beings, who seek pleasing renown, who seek good qualities, who seek the Dharma, who seek calm abiding, who seek insight, who seek the world of Brahmā, who seek the excellence of gods and humans, who seek to pass into nirvāṇa, and, Blessed One, who seek to realize all aims, should listen to this very samādhi of heroic progress, take it up, hold it, read it, explain it, and

cultivate it.

"And further, Blessed One, how should one apply oneself to this samādhi of heroic progress?"

The Blessed One said, "Jinamati, when a bodhisattva sees all phenomena as not entered into, at that time he has entered this samādhi of heroic progress. Jinamati, when a bodhisattva sees all phenomena as unobstructed, momentary, insubstantial, and free of attachment and anger, at that time he has entered this samādhi of heroic progress.

"However, Jinamati, application to this samādhi of heroic progress is not of one kind only. Jinamati, the causes of applying oneself to this samādhi of heroic progress are as many as the movements of the minds and conduct of all sentient beings. In this samädhi of heroic progress there are as many ways of entering into application as there are ways in which the minds and conduct of all sentient beings engage. In this samādhi of heroic progress there are as many ways of entering into application as there are movements of the faculties of all sentient beings.

"As many names and forms as all sentient beings have, so many names and forms should that bodhisattva display. Jinamati, whoever displays them in this way is applying himself to this samādhi of heroic progress. As many names, forms, and marks of all the buddhas as are seen, so many names, forms, and marks that are seen should that bodhisattva display. Jinamati, whoever displays them in this way is applying himself to this samādhi of heroic progress. As many arrays of qualities of the buddhafields of all the buddhas as are seen, so many arrays of qualities of buddhafields that are seen should that bodhisattva display. Jinamati, whoever displays them in this way is applying himself to this samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the bodhisattva Jinamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, applying oneself to this samādhi of heroic progress is extremely difficult to accomplish."

The Blessed One said, "Jinamati, that is why the bodhisattvas who abide in this samādhi of heroic progress are few, while those who engage in other, inferior samādhis are many."

Jinamati said, "Blessed One, this bodhisattva Maitreya is bound to just one more birth before unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and he will fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening after the Tathāgata.

Blessed One, has this bodhisattva Maitreya attained this samādhi of heroic progress?"

The Blessed One said, "Jinamati, all those bodhisattvas who abide on the tenth ground, who are bound to one more birth, and who have received empowerment, have attained this samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Maitreya, "Maitreya, show the bodhisattva Jinamati the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress."

Then at that time the bodhisattva Maitreya displayed such a manifestation of miraculous power, and the bodhisattva Jinamati and the entire assembly saw it. In all the Jambudvīpas there are in this great trichiliocosm, the bodhisattva Maitreya appeared. In some he dwelt in the world of the gods. In some he dwelt in the world of humans. In some he had gone forth. In some he lived as a householder. In some he served the Tathāgata, like Ānanda. In some he was great in wisdom, like Śāriputra. In some he was great in miraculous power, like Mahāmaudgalyāyana. In some he taught the ascetic practices, like Mahākāśyapa. In some he was a preacher of the Dharma, like Pūrṇa. In some he was eager for the training, like Rāhula. In some he upheld the Vinaya, like Upāli. In some he possessed the divine eye, like Aniruddha. In some he was a meditator, like Revata. In some he was foremost among those who dwell free of afflictions, like Subhūti.

In this way, throughout the entire trichiliocosm, the great thousandfold world system, the bodhisattva great being Maitreya was perceived as a foremost śrāvaka. In some towns and cities he went on his alms round, in some he taught the Dharma, and in some he appeared in inward meditative retreat. The bodhisattva Jinamati and the whole assembly saw the bodhisattva Maitreya entering the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress. Seeing this, they were delighted, joyful and glad, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, consider gold, bronze and brass that are free of the stain of iron and without dross. Wherever they are rubbed, there they do not lose the fine quality of gold. In the same way, Blessed One, these holy beings endowed with inconceivable qualities reveal inconceivable qualities however they are examined."

Then the bodhisattva Jinamati said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, as I see it, whoever has perfected this samādhi of heroic progress has perfected the Śrāvaka Vehicle, has perfected the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and has perfected the Great Vehicle."

The Blessed One declared: "Noble son, so it is. Whoever has perfected this samādhi of heroic progress has perfected every path of deliverance."

Then the elder Mahākāśyapa rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, as I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has said, and as I see it, Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, has in the past performed the deeds of a buddha, has in the past shown the seat of awakening, has in the past turned the wheel of Dharma, and has in the past displayed complete nirvāṇa."

When he had said this, the Blessed One declared to Mahākāśyapa: "Kāśyapa, so it is. It is just as you have said. Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, has in the past done the work of a buddha, has in the past shown the seat of awakening, has in the past turned the wheel of Dharma, and has in the past displayed complete nirvāṇa.

"Kāśyapa, long ago, in times past, countless eons ago, and still more countless, vast, immeasurable and inconceivable, and even further beyond that, at that time and on that occasion, to the south, three thousand buddha fields beyond this buddha field, there was a world system called Samā. It had no mountains or rocks, no stones, pebbles or gravel. It was as level as the palm of one's hand, and grass grew there that was soft and pleasant to the touch, like kācalindika cloth. There appeared in the world a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a Buddha, a Blessed One called Nāgavaṃśāgra. The Tathāgata Nāgavaṃśāgra dwelt there and attained awakening.

"Moreover, Kāśyapa, that Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete Buddha Nāgavaṃśāgra brought to maturity seven hundred million beings in the Bodhisattva Vehicle, brought to maturity eight hundred million in the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and brought to maturity ninety-six hundred thousand koṭis in the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Afterward, the Saṅgha of śrāvakas of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata Nāgavaṃśāgra, became immeasurable.

"Moreover, Kāśyapa, the lifespan of that Tathāgata Nāgavaṃśāgra was forty thousand years. Having worked for the benefit of the world with its gods, he passed into complete nirvāṇa, and his relics were widely spread. His stūpas numbered three hundred sixty million, and those beings made offerings to them. Kāśyapa, after that Blessed One Nāgavaṃśāgra passed into complete

nirvāṇa, the holy Dharma remained for a hundred thousand years.

"Kāśyapa, that Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete Buddha Nāgavaṃśāgra also prophesied of the bodhisattva called Jñānaprabha: 'After I have passed away, this bodhisattva called Jñānaprabha will fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, and his name will be the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete Buddha called Jñānaprabha.' Having made this prophesy, he passed into complete nirvāṇa.

"Kāśyapa, what do you think? If you should think that the one called the Tathāgata Nāgavaṃśāgra, who appeared at that time and on that occasion in the world system called Samā, was someone else, Kāśyapa, you should not regard it so. Why is that? Kāśyapa, it was this very Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, who at that time and on that occasion was the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete Buddha called Nāgavaṃśāgra.

"Kāśyapa, behold the domain of the samādhi of heroic progress! In this way one displays entering the womb, birth, going forth, the practice of austerities, going to the seat of awakening, taming Māra, fully awakening to perfect awakening, turning the wheel of Dharma, the great complete nirvāṇa, and the distribution of the relics, and yet does not abandon the nature of a bodhisattva. Even while passing utterly into complete nirvāṇa, one does not pass into complete nirvāṇa."

Then the elder Mahākāśyapa said this to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful: "Mañjuśrī, in displaying inconceivable states such as these, you do what is difficult."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Kāśyapa, what do you think? From what did this Vulture Peak arise? From what did this world system arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, all world systems arise like foam. They are brought into being by the inconceivable karmic maturation of sentient beings."

Mañjuśrī said, "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, just so. All phenomena, too, arise from the inconceivable maturation of karma. Therefore nothing here is difficult for me. Why is that? All phenomena are contrived, dependent on causes, and inert. Because they have no owner, they come about in whatever way one wishes. For whoever understands this principle, nothing at all is difficult. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, for those who have not seen the truths, it is extremely difficult to have faith in this principle. But for those who have seen the truths, the miraculous display of those who abide in the Dharma is not like that; to them it is no great wonder."

Then the Blessed One rose into the sky above to the height of about seven palm trees and sat there cross-legged. From his body he sent forth a light such that countless, immeasurable buddha fields in all ten directions were illuminated. The whole assembly saw immeasurable, countless buddhas, blessed ones, in the ten directions teaching this samādhi of heroic progress, and from here they heard that Dharma teaching too, with nothing missing and nothing added. All those buddhas, blessed ones, also appeared seated cross-legged in the sky above at the height of about seven palm trees, and all of them also appeared to send forth light from their bodies. The assemblies of those buddhas, blessed ones, in turn saw the Tathāgata Śākyamuni seated cross-legged in the sky above.

Then the whole assembly could be seen scattering flowers, garlands, incense, and ointments toward the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni. Those flowers went forth and appeared to remain as a canopy of flowers directly above the crown of the Blessed One's head. In these buddha fields as well, the bodhisattvas, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas scattered flowers toward those buddhas, blessed ones, and all those flowers appeared to remain as canopies of flowers directly above the crowns of those buddhas' heads.

Then the Blessed One withdrew those miracles, sat down on the seat just as it had been arranged, and said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Dṛḍhamati, the Tathāgata displayed this miracle of seeing the tathāgatas in order to increase the roots of virtue of sentient beings."

Dṛḍhamati, through this miracle of seeing the tathāgatas, eight thousand gods and humans generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Moreover, when the teaching on the consummation and culmination of this samādhi of heroic progress was explained, the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati attained this samādhi of heroic progress. Five hundred other bodhisattvas, as soon as they attained this samādhi of heroic progress, also beheld the miraculous displays of all the buddhas in the ten directions. They also gained illumination in entering the way of all phenomena. They attained the tenth ground and also received empowerment in all the qualities of a buddha. This great trichiliocosm world system shook in six ways and was pervaded by a great light. In the sky above, hundreds of thousands of divine instruments sounded, and a rain of flowers fell.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, take up this samādhi of heroic progress! Hold it! Recite it! Master it completely! And teach it extensively to others as well!"

Then Śakra, Holder of Meru's Summit, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is this? Are you entrusting this precious samādhi of heroic progress to the elder Ānanda, whose mindfulness and wisdom are one-sided, and who follows the words of others? Blessed One, by the truth of my true words, by which I shall spread this samādhi of heroic progress now and in the future, in the last five-hundred-year period, by that truth of true words, may all the trees that stand round about the mountain Vulture Peak become just like the Blessed One's tree at the seat of awakening! And may bodhisattvas be seen dwelling at every one of them!"

As soon as Śakra, Holder of Meru's Summit, had spoken these words, all those trees became like the tree of the seat of awakening, and bodhisattvas could also be seen dwelling at the foot of every one of those trees of the seat of awakening. From those trees of the seat of awakening a voice came forth: "Śakra, Holder of Meru's Summit, it is just as you have said. Now and in the future you will spread this precious samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas spoke with one voice: "Suppose the Tathāgata's life were to last for an eon, and he were to teach the Dharma based on the śrāvaka vehicle, and with each Dharma teaching the Tathāgata turned the wheel of Dharma, and as many beings as he tamed were tamed. Far more supreme than that is the benefit done for beings when this samādhi of heroic progress is taught. Why is that? Blessed One, all those beings are tamed in the śrāvaka vehicle; they do not come near even a hundredth part of the bodhisattvas' discipline, and so on, until they do not come near even its tiniest fraction. For this samādhi of heroic progress, through which bodhisattvas have gone forth, go forth, and will go forth, is of such great measure."

"Therefore, Blessed One, bodhisattvas who wish to go forth by every path by which bodhisattvas go forth should strive in this samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati said this to the Blessed One (the Buddha): "Blessed One, how long is the lifespan of the Tathāgata? How long will it be until the Tathāgata passes completely into final nirvāṇa and enters parinirvāṇa?"

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, to the east, thirty-two thousand buddha fields beyond this buddha field, there is a world called Adorned. There the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays, is now present, living, sustaining himself, and teaching the Dharma. Dṛḍhamati, my lifespan is exactly as long as the lifespan of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays."

Dṛḍhamati asked, "Blessed One, how long is the lifespan of that Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays?"

The Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, go and ask that very Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays, and he himself will answer you."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati drew on the power of the Buddha, the power of samādhi, and the strength of his own roots of virtue. In a single instant, a moment, a flash, he went to the world called Adorned. He bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays, circled the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side. Then he said this to that Blessed One: "Blessed One, how long is your lifespan? How long will it be until you pass completely into final nirvāṇa and enter parinirvāṇa?"

That Blessed One said, "Dṛḍhamati, it is the same as the lifespan of the Blessed One Śākyamuni. Dṛḍhamati, the lifespan is seven hundred incalculable eons. The lifespan of the Blessed One Śākyamuni is exactly as long as my own."

Then the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati was filled with wonder. Once more he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays, and circled him three times. In a single instant, a moment, a flash, he came back to the Sahā world and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays, declared: 'My lifespan is seven hundred incalculable eons, and the lifespan of the Blessed One Śākyamuni is exactly as long as mine.'"

Then, through the power of the Buddha, the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, as I understand the meaning of what the

Blessed One has said, and as I think it over, the Blessed One himself is the one called the Tathāgata Vairocana, King of Magical Display Adorned with Light Rays, in that world Adorned. I think that under that very name you teach the Dharma for the help and happiness of sentient beings."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the venerable Ānanda: "Excellent, excellent, Ānanda! Through the power of the Buddha you have understood perfectly. I myself am he. In the world called Adorned I teach the Dharma under that very name, for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings. Ānanda, that too is a magical display of the samādhi of heroic progress."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Dṛḍhamati, my lifespan, then, is seven hundred incalculable eons. After that I will pass completely into final nirvāṇa and enter parinirvāṇa."

When the whole assembly heard of this lifespan of the Buddha, they marveled with one voice and said: "How wondrous is everything about the buddhas, the blessed ones, the great beings: their abiding, the miracles of the buddhas' magical displays, their inconceivable and distinctive qualities, their realization, and their having become the supreme leaders in conduct! Since the lifespan of the Blessed One Śākyamuni is seven hundred incalculable eons, here in this Sahā world his lifespan only appears to be short. May all sentient beings attain this lifespan and this samādhi of heroic progress!"

Then the Blessed One again said to the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, "Dṛḍhamati, wherever this teaching of the samādhi of heroic progress is practiced, whether in a village, a town, a district, a country, a monastery, or a hermitage, the māras and the gods of Māra's realm, who watch for an opening and look for faults, will find no opening there. Dṛḍhamati, if a teacher of the Dharma copies this samādhi of heroic progress in writing, reads it, receives its transmission, recites it, or keeps it, he can expect to have no fear of humans or nonhumans. Beyond that, he can expect to obtain twenty kinds of inconceivable and distinctive qualities.

What are the twenty? They are these: inconceivable merit, inconceivable wisdom, inconceivable skillful means, inconceivable eloquence, inconceivable illumination of the Dharma, inconceivable entry into the doors of dhāraṇī, inconceivable entry into the doors of the Dharma, an inconceivable vessel of mindfulness, intelligence, and realization, inconceivable accomplishment of the higher knowledges, inconceivable entry into the languages of all sentient beings, inconceivable entry into the conduct and dispositions of sentient

beings, inconceivable seeing of buddhas, inconceivable hearing of the Dharma, inconceivable ripening of sentient beings, inconceivable magical displays of samādhi, inconceivable accomplishment of the qualities of buddhafields arrayed with qualities, inconceivable beauty of form and of the major marks, inconceivable praise, qualities, fame, and renown, inconceivable training in the perfections, and inconceivable realization of the Dharma.

Dṛḍhamati, a Dharma teacher who is diligent in this samādhi of heroic progress, if he writes it down, reads it, receives its transmission, recites it, or teaches it, acquires these twenty inconceivable distinctive qualities. Therefore, Dṛḍhamati, a son or daughter of good family who wishes to acquire qualities in this life or in other lives should strive to write down, read, receive the transmission of, recite, and explain this samādhi of heroic progress.

Furthermore, Dṛḍhamati, compared with a son or daughter of good family who, wishing for awakening, practices the six perfections for a hundred thousand eons, if someone, upon merely hearing this samādhi of heroic progress, is not discouraged, is not afraid, is not terrified, does not become terrified, and has faith in it, that person will go forth far more swiftly to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. What need is there to speak of one who, having heard it, gives its transmission or explains it to others?

One who wishes not to be afraid upon hearing of the inconceivability of the Tathāgata should listen to this precious samādhi of heroic progress. One who wishes not to reject teachings never heard before upon hearing them, who wishes to understand intentional speech, and who wishes to realize wisdom made directly manifest should have faith in this samādhi of heroic progress.

When this samādhi of heroic progress was being taught, countless, immeasurable sentient beings truly set out for unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Those who came to abide on the bodhisattva grounds were even more immeasurable than that. Those who attained acceptance were even more immeasurable than that. Those bound to just one more birth also became immeasurable. Eighteen thousand bodhisattvas attained this samādhi of heroic progress. Eighty-six thousand living beings generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Twenty-eight thousand monks and nuns had their minds liberated from the defilements without further grasping. In eighty-six thousand laymen and laywomen the Dharma eye regarding phenomena was purified, free of dust and free of stain. Thirty-six hundred billion gods attained clear realization of the Dharma.

Then Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain to me such words born of meaning, words by which future bodhisattvas, training in the trainings of the bodhisattva great beings of the past and becoming adept in them, will obtain unbroken eloquence. Blessed One, please explain those words born of meaning by which dhāraṇī will be obtained.

That will be for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, and for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude, of gods and humans. It will be so that future bodhisattva great beings, in later times, in the final period, will uphold the unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening that the Tathāgata accomplished over many tens of millions of eons; so that, after the true Dharma has declined, they will make the lamp of the Dharma blaze once again; so that they will set to work in order to uphold the true Dharma; so that they will see the true limit and the suchness of all phenomena; so that they will subdue those with overweening pride; so that they will subdue and crush the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), the followers of other practices, and the wandering ascetics; and so that, following the turning of the wheel of Dharma, they will turn these wheels: the wheel of not apprehending any phenomenon, the unmoved wheel, the nonabiding wheel, the unmixed wheel, the undisparaged wheel, the wheel of emptiness, the wheel of signlessness, the wheel of wishlessness, the wheel of characteristiclessness, the wheel of all phenomena, the wheel that rightly teaches the meaning of words and letters, the wheel of nonformation, the inexpressible wheel, the wheel not examined by dissection, the wheel of the sameness of all phenomena, the wheel that teaches the sameness of meaning, the wheel that declares phenomena, the unobscured wheel, and the wheel of nonattachment to all phenomena; and so that, as soon as that wheel is turned, the world with its gods and humans will tremble and be terrified.

Blessed One, please explain extensively those words born of meaning which cannot be overcome by any of those with manifest pride, nor by any of the tīrthikas, the followers of other practices, the wandering ascetics, and the opponents. That will become a light for the world with its gods, humans, and asuras."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said this to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful: "Mañjuśrī, excellent, excellent, that you think to ask the Tathāgata about this matter!"

"You have set out for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, for the sake of the great multitude, for the welfare, the benefit, and the happiness of gods and humans, and for the sake of present and future bodhisattvas. Mañjuśrī, these words with which you make your request have arisen through the power of the Tathāgata. Therefore, Mañjuśrī, listen well and carefully, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain."

Saying, "Excellent, Blessed One," Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One spoke as follows:

"Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are nonabiding, because they have no movement. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without grasping, because they are without attachment, aversion, and delusion. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are not apprehended, because they are without conceptual thought. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without instigation, because they are undisturbed. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are undisturbed, because they are without separation. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are indivisible, because they are without entity. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without perception, because they are without characteristics. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without characteristics, because they are nonexistent. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without core, because formations are not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are not manifestly fashioned, because sentient beings are not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are unconditioned, because an agent is not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without a seer, because the eye is not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are free of consciousness, because the mind is not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are of boundless extent, because they are measureless. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are immeasurable, because sentient beings are immeasurable. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without obscuration, because a remedy is not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without remedy, because of their sameness. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are the same, because diversity is not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without diversity, because inferior, superior, and equal are not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena do not pass on, because they do not come. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena have not come, because they have no arising. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are without dependence, because the three times are the same. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are beyond the three times, because past, future, and present are not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are like a vajra, because division is not apprehended. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are

unmoving, because they are without destruction. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are undestroyed, because the limit of reality is not cognized. Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are equal to nirvāṇa, because they are not apprehended.

"Mañjuśrī, these words of nonattachment are words without signs. They are words without elaboration. They are words without turbidity. They are unmistaken words. They are unwavering words. They are words that cannot be carried off. They cannot be overpowered by any opponents. They are not overpowered by any of the proud. This is not for non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and opponents. It is not for those who hold views of apprehended objects, views of a person, views of a sentient being, or views of signs. It is not for any sentient beings who engage in formations.

"Mañjuśrī, these are words born of the meaning. Through them bodhisattva great beings attain the generation of the power of wisdom, and they also fully realize all phenomena. Mañjuśrī, to bodhisattva great beings who abide thus and have set out thus, the buddhas, the blessed ones, grant eloquence.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: the king of beasts, the maned lion of noble lineage, is not afraid, not terrified, and not frightened of any foxes or four-footed creatures that come along. It does not so much as bristle its fur. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva great being who has trained in such non-apprehensions is not afraid, not terrified, and not frightened of anyone, from all opponents and wandering ascetics who hold views of apprehended objects, up to those who engage in fashioning. Why is that? Because they roar the great lion's roar in this way. Mañjuśrī, if even bodhisattvas, because they do not abide in any phenomena, come to have such distinguished qualities, what need is there to mention those who have fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening?"

When the Blessed One had said this, and the Sugata had spoken thus, the Teacher further said the following:

All phenomena do not abide,
Because by nature they are void.
They have no place of abiding;
Therefore they are called "nonabiding."

Because phenomena are by nature luminous,
They have no real entity.
Where there is no entity,
That is the purity of phenomena.

Since no entity exists,
There is no attachment there.
Where there is no attachment,
For that reason it is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are like that;
In that there are no words.
The ocean of many phenomena
Is what is called dhāraṇī.

Where there is no entity,
There that too is not conceived.
Where nothing is conceived as a self,
Know that this is dhāraṇī itself.

All phenomena are wholly at peace;
By nature they have no characteristics.
Whoever enters that with wisdom
Will swiftly obtain dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are unmoving;
In that there is no world.
Where no world exists,
That is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are unestablished.
Where there is no entity,
And where nothing at all is established,
That is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena cannot be grasped;
They have no beginning.
Where there is no beginning,
Therefore know it as dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are unborn;
They arise wholly from conceptual thought.
Where there is no conceptual thought,
Therefore know it as dhāraṇī.

All phenomena abide as nonexistent;
They are taught as beyond conception.
In this, nothing at all is taught;

Therefore it is called "teaching."

All phenomena are unmixed;
In this there is no essential nature either.
Where nothing is observed as a phenomenon,
There, there is no distinction.

All phenomena are unattached;
They are equal to space and like it.
That is the nature of phenomena,
And that too is what is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena have a single characteristic;
Here there is not even one.
Here there is no distinct nature;
Therefore they have a single characteristic.

All phenomena are without characteristics;
In that there is no entity.
Where there is no entity,
Therefore it is called dhāraṇī.

Since all phenomena are void,
In that there is no essential nature.
Where no entity is observed,
Know that as dhāraṇī.

All phenomena do not abide,
And nothing rises up either.
Where there is no rising,
That is called nirvāṇa.

All phenomena are uncompounded;
Sentient beings, too, are not there.
Whatever is the nature of sentient beings,
That is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are unmade;
There is no maker in them either.
Where there is no work of karma,
That is called dhāraṇī.

Since the eye does not exist,
No phenomena whatever are seen.
Where the eye is not observed,
That is called "absence."

Since mind does not exist,
Phenomena are free of consciousness.
Since there is no mind and no knowing,
There is no consciousness.

Where there is no knowing, and likewise
No unknowing either,
And where mind does not exist,
Just that much is wisdom.

As long as there is conceptualization,
There is wisdom and unknowing.
When conception and obscuration are gone,
That is what is called wisdom.

All phenomena have no entity;
They are explained as mere names.
Wisdom and unknowing too
Know to be just the same.

All phenomena are nonexistent;
Here there is nothing at all.
Where phenomena do not exist,
That is the supreme Dharma.

All phenomena, by their nature,
Are taught to be immeasurable.
Whatever is the nature of sentient beings,
That is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are hollow;
They have no core.
Where there is no core,
That is the characteristic of dhāraṇī.

All phenomena have no antidote;
Thus they have a single characteristic.
For phenomena without characteristics

No antidote exists.

All phenomena are without distinction;
There is no highest and no lowest.
Here there is nothing alike;
For that reason it is called dhāraṇī.

Because they are equal and have entered sameness,
In all phenomena there is no variety.
Where variety does not exist,
That is called dhāraṇī.

Since all phenomena are nonexistent,
Nothing comes here,
And nothing else passes on from here.
That is the true nature of phenomena.

Since all phenomena have not come,
Nothing gathers here.
Where there is no gathering,
That is called dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are inconceivable;
They have neither existence nor nonexistence.
In that there is no grasping;
That is the characteristic of dhāraṇī.

Since by nature they are selfless,
All phenomena are without dependence.
Whatever is explained as selfless,
Therefore know it as without entity.
As having passed beyond the three realms
Understand dhāraṇī thoroughly.
Since phenomena are not attained,
That is declared to be dhāraṇī.

All phenomena are like a vajra;
In them there is no distinction.
Thus entities are empty;
For that reason there is no entity.

All phenomena are unmoving;
In them there is no destruction.
In them there is no birth;
For that reason there is no destruction.

If all phenomena are indestructible,
That is to see them truly.
In the supreme awakening of such ones,
Nothing whatever is realized.
Since not even the subtlest phenomenon is observed,
This is explained as the awakening of the buddhas.
All phenomena cannot be grasped;
That is the characteristic of awakening.

Because form itself has no intrinsic nature,
Dhāraṇī is explained as without form.
Yet apart from form, elsewhere,
Dhāraṇī will not be found.
Though form has no essential nature,
It is called "essential nature."
If one knows essential nature in this way,
Dhāraṇī comes near.

As for the writing of this dhāraṇī,
It too rests on mere names.
The phenomenon definitively called "dhāraṇī"
Does not exist.

Know the eye as dhāraṇī;
That is what the wheel teaches.
Non-attachment to phenomena
Is what is called dhāraṇī.

Applying this in the same way:

Know the mind as dhāraṇī;
That is what the wheel teaches.
Non-attachment to phenomena
Is what is explained as dhāraṇī.

Here the explanation is limitless.
If phenomena are understood in this way,

Whatever is without any object of focus,
In every case, is called dhāraṇī.
Not seeing many objects of focus,
One teaches without abiding:
All phenomena are without entity,
Without sign and without characteristic.
Whoever, wishing for dhāraṇī, sets forth,
Having understood phenomena in this way,
And teaches thoroughly without attachment,
Has established the dhāraṇī.

Mañjuśrī, long ago, in times past, there appeared a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, a guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Lamp of the Dharma Tālala. His buddha field was called Free of Dust. It was level, delightful, beautiful, lovely to behold, pure, prosperous, flourishing, and filled with many humans and people.

Mañjuśrī, that world system was made of beryl and was laid out in a checkerboard pattern with threads of gold, and in every square of the pattern there were jewel trees bearing flowers and fruit. That great earth was also pleasant to the touch, like kācalindika cloth. Mañjuśrī, in that buddha field there were no animals, hungry ghosts, or asuras at all. Mañjuśrī, whatever beings were born in that buddha field were endowed with the ten paths of virtuous action. That buddha field was utterly pure, excellent in every respect and complete in every respect. Its city was called Without Arising.

Mañjuśrī, at that time the lifespan of humans was a full one hundred thousand years, and no one died before reaching it. Mañjuśrī, in that city called Without Arising there lived a king called Vijaya, and, Mañjuśrī, the king called Vijaya had a thousand sons. And, Mañjuśrī, the king called Vijaya, together with his thousand sons, served the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Lamp of the Dharma Tālala, together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas, with robes, food, bedding and seats, medicine for the sick, and other requisites. He also honored them with every requisite for their comfort; he held them in esteem, revered them, attended them, and made offerings to them.

Mañjuśrī, then King Vijaya, together with his thousand sons, asked the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Lamp of the Dharma Tālala, about this entire Dharma discourse. And that Tathāgata, knowing his superior intention, taught this Dharma discourse. As soon as they heard it, King Vijaya and his thousand sons came to understand the Dharma. Having heard this Dharma discourse, they attained uninterrupted eloquence.

Therefore, Mañjuśrī, whether now or after the Tathāgata has passed away, any son or daughter of good family who wishes for this uninterrupted eloquence, this unobstructed eloquence, should strive in the Dharma of such a profound state free of attachment, and should train in it. They should take up such profound words of Dharma, master them, and recite them. Having mastered such a profound Dharma discourse, they should teach it to others as well. They should be without stinginess regarding any Dharma.

When he had spoken thus, Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, said to the Blessed One, "For the sake of beings of the future, may the Blessed One please bless this Dharma discourse so that, in the future, in the last times, in the final age, it will be practiced once again."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the request that Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, had made, blessed this Dharma discourse. When the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha blessed this Dharma discourse, those to be trained through acceptance of the Dharma attained acceptance.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda, Mañjuśrī, the Youthful, the bodhisattva Dṛḍhamati, the bodhisattva Maitreya, the other bodhisattva great beings besides them, those great śrāvakas, that whole assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble Great Vehicle sūtra called the samādhi of heroic progress (Śūraṅgama).

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Śākyaprabha and the chief editor and translator, the monk Ratnarakṣita, and it was also revised according to the new terminology.

It is contained in the Sūtra section.

Translator's Notes

• Most bodhisattva names in the list are rendered by their meaning, since their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence; only Mañjuśrī, Maitreya, and Dṛḍhamati are given in Sanskrit. The text gives seventy-two thousand bodhisattvas at first and thirty-two thousand at the end of the list; both numbers are translated as they stand.
• "The certainty of the śrāvakas" renders the technical term niyāma, the fixed entry into a given vehicle's path that would preclude the bodhisattva's course.
• The samādhi named here (Tibetan "going heroically") is the Śūraṅgama samādhi of the sūtra's title; it is rendered "the samādhi of heroic progress" throughout. The "answers" to Dṛḍhamati's questions render □□□□□□□□ in its sense of a reply to a question, not a prophecy. "Young gods" translates □□□□□□□ (devaputra).
• The name of the Brahmā rendered "Abiding in Sameness" is translated from the Tibetan; I could not confidently identify its Sanskrit form. The Buddha's reply about phenomena being "present through projection" and arising "from conceptual imagining" is terse in the Tibetan and its phrasing admits other construals.
• The name of the Brahmā, rendered "Abiding in Sameness," and the name of the god (devaputra), rendered "Throne," are translated from their Tibetan meaning because their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. "The patience that conforms to the Dharma" renders the technical term ānulomikī dharmakṣānti, the acceptance that accords with the true nature of phenomena.
• The phrase rendered "the ocean of omniscience, so hard to fathom" contains the word dug can pa, literally "poisonous," which makes no sense in context; it has been left untranslated as a probable copyist's slip whose correct reading cannot be recovered with confidence. The pair rendered "what applies and what does not apply" ('gre ba and 'gre ba ma yin pa) is of uncertain meaning, perhaps referring to consistent and inconsistent modes of exposition.
• The phrase rendered "the nirvāṇa in which the aggregates are utterly absent" alludes to nirvāṇa without remainder; the point is that the bodhisattva displays final passing yet never actually enters it. "Beaten drums" renders □□□□□□□□□□, whose instrument is not certain. In the list of beings brought to maturity, the hearing, seeing, and so on are taken as acts of the beings directed toward the bodhisattva.
• In the line rendered "In various kinds of sequence," the word □□□□□ does not carry its glossary sense of "tantra." In the context of skill with words, it means a series or arrangement. The following line, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, appears to refer to compositional patterns, pairing and inverted or interlaced order. "The powerful one" renders □□□□□□□ as an epithet of the bodhisattva, not the guardian Īśāna.
• The closing phrase of the section on patience, rendered "remains without appearance and without decline," is terse in the Tibetan and its exact sense is uncertain; it may mean that his patience never lapses or is lost. In the passage on patience there is a play on the Tibetan word for patience, which also means "to accept": he speaks of patience, yet accepts nothing as permanent.
• The term rendered "non-Buddhist sects" (ya mtshan can) is unusual. The context, people one "goes forth among" who hold their own views and believe in purification, points to rival ascetic orders (tīrthikas). In the phrase "train in just the same way," the Tibetan word elsewhere rendered "suchness" is used here in its ordinary sense of "in the same way."
• "He does not let go of passing into nirvāṇa, yet he teaches the Dharma so that others may pass into nirvāṇa" renders the Tibetan as written (mi gtong, "does not give up"). The surrounding sentences all follow the pattern "he does not apprehend X, yet he teaches X," so this line may originally have followed the same pattern. It is translated here as it stands.
• The two medicines, "Lovely to Behold" and "Separation," are translated from their Tibetan meanings, since their Sanskrit names cannot be identified with confidence; the first may correspond to Sudarśana. The terms listed under the perfection of diligence, rendered here as

striving, distinguishing, seclusion and discerning, are terse and their exact sense is uncertain.
• The Brahmā named □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit name, so the name is translated by its meaning as "Supreme Loving-kindness." "The second patience, the concordant patience" reflects the traditional series of three patiences, in which concordant patience (ānulomikī kṣānti) is the second, leading to patience with the unborn nature of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti).
• The name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ has been translated by meaning ("Holder of the Summit of Meru"); a Sanskrit form along the lines of Merukūṭadhara or Meruśikharadhara is likely but not confirmed. Kauśika is a standard epithet of Śakra (Indra). The sense of Holder of the Summit of Meru's reply to Śakra ("even if the complete form body ... could be shown ...") is somewhat obscure in the Tibetan and has been rendered closely.
• The name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by its meaning, "the Śakra called Holder of Meru's Summit," because I could not identify a securely attested Sanskrit form. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Gopaka. This is the god who, in the canonical tradition, was formerly the Śākya woman Gopikā, which fits his account here of being transformed from a woman's body. In □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□ is the number ten thousand: the phrase means "twelve thousand young gods" and is not the name "Throne." Gopaka's line about those who arouse the mind of awakening repeats the same verb twice in the Tibetan. Given the third, future form, I have taken this as past, present and future.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Gopaka, the young god who in this sūtra was formerly the Śākya woman Gopikā; this accounts for the shift from female to male in the opening exchange. The name of the young god □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence in Sanskrit and is translated by meaning as "Manifest Buddha Intellect." The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "late in the night, when everyone was asleep."
• The name of the young god, Tibetan "Sangs rgyas blo gros mngon sum," could not be identified with confidence in a Sanskrit form, so it is translated by meaning as "Manifest Buddha Intellect." The item □□□□ in Mahākāśyapa's equipment is unclear; it is taken as a robe ("lower robe," cf. □□□□□□□), but this is uncertain.
• The young god's name, Tibetan sangs rgyas blo gros mngon sum, has been translated by its meaning ("Manifest Buddha Intelligence") because I cannot securely confirm the Sanskrit form. In the assembly's speech the third "what need to speak of" repeats "those who hear" as it stands in the Tibetan, and it is translated as written. "Lordly excellence" renders khyu mchog, literally "the bull of the herd," meaning the foremost or most eminent manifestation.
• The dialogue alternates between a bodhisattva addressed as "son of good family" and a young god; the Tibetan marks each turn only with "he said," and the speaker is identified from the form of address. The play on "going" (Tibetan 'gro ba, Sanskrit -gama in Śūraṅgama) runs through the passage and is kept literal. The phrase rendered "he does not pass beyond that suchness of nirvāṇa" could also be read as "that suchness of nirvāṇa does not pass beyond either."
• The young god's name, Tibetan Sangs rgyas blo gros mngon sum, could not be confidently matched to a Sanskrit form, so it is translated by meaning as "Manifest Buddha Intelligence." Likewise the future buddha's name is rendered by meaning, "King Renowned for Stainless Light." The clause about sixty-two eons is ambiguous: it may mean that no buddha appears during that span. The Tibetan as written reads "a buddha will appear," and it is translated that way.
• The world name "Inspiring Faith on Sight," the buddha's name "King Renowned for Stainless Light," and the young god's name "Manifest Buddha Mind" are translated from the Tibetan, because I cannot securely confirm their Sanskrit forms. In Śāriputra's remark, the phrase rendered "to cause interference" (literally something like "to strive with the eye") is obscure; the sense of hostile interference is taken from context.

• The bodhisattva's name, literally "Untainted by the Domain of Māra's Activity," is given in the Sanskrit form Māragocarānupalipta used in modern scholarship on this sūtra; it is a reconstruction, so the literal meaning is also given at first mention. The verb rendered "push through" (□□□□□) is unusual; the sense is clearly that one should go through such fire-filled fields to hear the samādhi's name.
• The bodhisattva's name is given in its Sanskrit form Māragocarānupalipta, as reconstructed in Lamotte's study of this sūtra, with its meaning glossed on first use. "Patience in conformity with the Dharma" renders the technical attainment of conformable acceptance (ānulomikī kṣānti).
• "Renown" renders the term that elsewhere means "verse" (Skt. śloka), which in the stock phrase "gain, honor, and śloka" means praise or fame. The motives rendered "to mock it" and "to disparage it" are somewhat uncertain readings of the Tibetan verbs.
• "Some bodhisattvas who have been slack" renders □□□□□□□□, literally "lazy." The word sits awkwardly with the diligence described next. The sense seems to be that these bodhisattvas strive all the harder for lack of a prophecy, but the precise force of the word is uncertain.

"With signs and with deliberate effort" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, likely Sanskrit sanimitta and sābhisaṃskāra. It means the perfections are still practiced with conceptual marks.

The householder's name □□□□□□□□ could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit form, so it is translated by its meaning. The Sanskrit form Siṃhanādanādin for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is a probable reconstruction.
• Three bodhisattva names could not be confidently matched to Sanskrit forms and are rendered by their meaning: "Endowed with Peace," "Hero of Wisdom," and "Untainted by the Sphere of Māra's Activity" (perhaps Māragocarānupalipta).

"Forbearance" (kṣānti) here refers to the bodhisattva's acceptance that phenomena do not arise.

The word rendered "disciplined conduct" is uncertain in the Tibetan, and the sense is approximate.
• The bodhisattva's name, literally "Untainted by the Domain of Māra's Activity," is given in the Sanskrit form Māragocarānupalipta, following Lamotte's reconstruction. "A billion" renders "a hundred koṭis" (100 × 10,000,000). The Buddha's reply begins in the first person ("I abided in this samādhi") and then shifts to a general description of what a bodhisattva does; the translation keeps this shift.
• The world system □□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered by its meaning, "Single Lamp," since its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence. "Bull-like preeminence" renders □□□□□□□□, literally "the bull of the herd," meaning foremost excellence. The paradox that bodhisattvas "by passing utterly into final nirvāṇa, do not pass into final nirvāṇa" is the sūtra's own wording.
• "Arhats who have completed their investigation" renders the uncertain phrase brnag pa yongs su rdzogs pa; the parallel Chinese simply lists arhats, those perfect in view, stream-enterers and faith-followers, so the qualifier's exact sense is unclear. "Bodily witnessed" renders lus mngon du byas pa (Skt. kāyasākṣin), meaning direct personal experience. The name of the world system "Single Lamp" and the buddha's name are translated from the Tibetan, as no Sanskrit form is securely attested here.
• "The certainty of the śrāvakas" renders "the certainty" (niyāma), the śrāvaka's irreversible entry into fixed liberation, which the bodhisattva declines to enter; "of the śrāvakas" is added for clarity. "Regional king" renders a term for a local or petty king (likely Skt. koṭṭarāja), contrasted with the universal monarch.
• The young god's name, the buddha field, the future Tathāgata, and the eon are translated

literally ("Essence of the Stainless Moon," "Adorned with All Jewels," "Single Jewel Parasol," "Illumination") because their Sanskrit forms could not be confirmed. The god may be Vimalacandragarbha and the eon may be Vairocana. The phrase "the words of others" renders the term for śrāvakas who depend on hearing teachings from others. The number of Mañjuśrī's nirvāṇas renders "koṭi-khrag-khrig" as koṭi-niyutas; the exact value of that compound numeral is approximate.

• The eon name rendered "Illumination" translates the Tibetan "rnam par snang ba." The Sanskrit original is not certain (possibly Prabhāsa or Vairocana), so the meaning is given in English. The phrase "koṭis of niyutas" follows the standard Sanskrit compound behind the Tibetan number expression; the total is thirty-six hundred thousand of these.

• "Faultless state" renders the Tibetan for niyāma, the fixed certainty of the śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha path that, once entered, precludes the Great Vehicle. "One of the eighth rank" (aṣṭamaka) is the candidate for stream-entry, counted eighth from the arhat. The phrase rendered "are tied up in a knot" is obscure; it seems to mean that such beings are closed off or bound, but the exact sense is uncertain. "Their own former disposition" interprets "their own nature," referring to the lesser inclination toward the śrāvaka path.

• The bodhisattva's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Jinamati on the basis of the standard equation □□□□□□ = jina; the original might instead have been Jayamati. The opening sentences continue a list spoken to the Blessed One in humble register; they are rendered as instructions ("one who seeks X should ..."), as the grammar requires. □□□□□□□ is rendered "insubstantial" (lacking core, hollow).

• The bodhisattva □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Jinamati, a likely but not certain reconstruction. Nāgavaṃśāgra (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), Samā (□□□□□) and Jñānaprabha (□□□□□□□□□□) follow standard reconstructions for this sūtra. The opening of the gold simile (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is somewhat obscure. It has been read as "gold, bronze and brass."

• The phrase rendered "and so on, until they do not come near even its tiniest fraction" abbreviates a stock series of ever smaller fractions ending in a term (Tibetan rgyu, Sanskrit upaniṣad) denoting the most infinitesimal part; the translation gives the sense rather than a literal "up to not even the cause." The sentence beginning "Dṛḍhamati, through this miracle" is addressed to Dṛḍhamati in the Tibetan but reads as narration of its effect; it has been kept as written. The epithet of Śakra, literally "Meru Summit Holder," is rendered in English since no Sanskrit form can be confirmed.

• The world name □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("adorned, embellished") and the long name of that buddha are translated by meaning. Their Sanskrit forms are not certain, though Lamotte reconstructs the buddha's name as Vairocanaraśmipratimaṇḍitavikurvaṇarāja. The phrase "only appears to be short" renders □□□, which suggests appearance rather than fact. This fits the doctrinal point that the Buddha's apparent brief life in the Sahā world is a display.

• The number □□□□□□□□ is a large Tibetan numeral usually given as a hundred billion; "thirty-six hundred billion gods" follows that value, though dictionaries vary. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ in Mañjuśrī's request is elliptical; it has been rendered "cannot be overcome by" as the evident sense.

• The term rendered "without core" translates a Tibetan expression meaning hollow or lacking essential substance. "Words that cannot be carried off" renders a phrase meaning that these words cannot be taken away or refuted.

• In the stanza on phenomena being unborn, the Tibetan reads "realization" (rtogs pa) in the second line, but the following line speaks of "conceptual thought" (rtog pa); the translation follows the evident reading "conceptual thought." Throughout, the verses play on the Tibetan word for dhāraṇī (gzungs), whose root means "to hold" or "to grasp" (compare "cannot be grasped," "no grasping").

• "That is what the wheel teaches" renders the Tibetan literally. Its exact sense here, perhaps

the formulaic pattern applied in turn to each sense faculty or the wheel of Dharma, is uncertain. The buddha's name, Lamp of the Dharma Tālala, contains an unidentified element (ta la la) that I have left as transliterated. I translated the buddha field's name "Free of Dust" literally; it may reflect Sanskrit Virajā. The city's name "Without Arising" is also a literal translation.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.